

LIVING & WORK LITERACY **4**

WORK EDUCATION



Brian Parker



Quality ready-to-use
resources



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Brian Parker



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Instant Lessons
An imprint of Blake Education Pty Ltd
ABN 074 266 023
108 Main Road
Clayton South VIC 3169
Ph: +61 3 9558 4433
www.blake.com.au

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Introduction

The photocopiable activities in this book explore the work environment. Throughout these topics, students will investigate different employment roles and the regulations and issues that relate to employment. There are also specific topics aimed at preparing students to find work through practical tasks such as work experience, writing a resume and preparing for a job interview. Concepts are explored through a range of challenging short answer, class discussion and research activities.

Topics contained in this book are suitable for secondary school subjects in years 7–10 that teach young people about the practical skills and knowledge that they need to participate fully in society. Other books in this series cover topics such as money and being a wise consumer, government and law, and managing small enterprises.

Contents

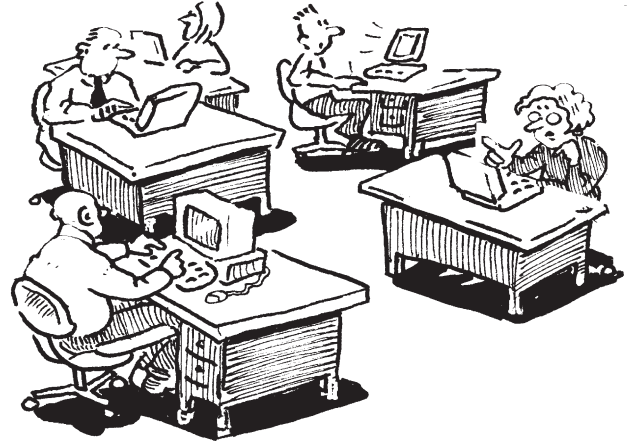
1	THE WORKPLACE	4
2	PAYMENT FOR WORK	6
3	CHANGING WORK PATTERNS	8
4	PERMANENT OR CASUAL? FULL-TIME OR PART-TIME?	10
5	WORKING CONDITIONS	12
6	SEXUAL HARASSMENT	14
7	EQUAL OPPORTUNITY	16
8	WORKPLACE AGREEMENTS	18
9	UNEMPLOYMENT	20
10	WORKPLACE PROTECTION	22
11	EMPLOYMENT RELATIONS	24
12	INDUSTRIAL DISPUTES	26
13	TRADE UNIONS	28
14	PAYING INCOME TAX	30
15	SUPERANNUATION	32
16	APPLYING FOR A JOB	34
17	PREPARING A RESUME	36
18	WORK EXPERIENCE AND VOCATIONAL TRAINING	37
19	THE JOB INTERVIEW	38
20	CAREER PLANNING	40
21	PROMOTION	42
22	WORK WORDFIND	44
	SELECTED ANSWERS	45

I The workplace.....

What is a workplace?

A workplace was once seen as an office, a factory, shop, building site or outdoor location where work was carried out. It was also regarded as a place where workers or employees worked for an employer and provided their labour in return for an income. While this is still true, the workplaces of today are much more varied. For many people, their workplace is not necessarily a fixed location. For example, truck drivers or delivery-van drivers, and some salespeople who have use of a company car to make contact with customers.

Working from home is also a choice that some people have today. Some may use sewing machines while others use laptops, mobile phones and various other communication devices. Giving work to people who work at home under contract is called outsourcing.



Their first job

Matt and **Ilsa** were young and keen, fresh out of school and they had just been offered their first real job. A year later they both felt they had done well and they wanted to share their knowledge. Therefore they decided to write down some suggestions for others starting a new job. They pointed out that starting a new job can be quite stressful or overwhelming at first, so it is important to consider how to ease the transition from school to work. Here are some of the things they suggested.

- Check out the best way to get to work to make sure you arrive on time.
- Become familiar with the workplace environment, e.g. where are toilets, kitchen or staffrooms? You need to know your way around the building or work site to avoid becoming lost and embarrassed.
- Learn your job responsibilities. This may take some time, so be patient.
- Ask questions. This has the double effect of providing information and showing how keen you are to succeed. Do not be afraid to admit mistakes and to seek help from your supervisor or employer.
- Become involved in the social life of the workplace. There are usually many opportunities to meet co-workers socially and you can learn a lot over lunch or drinks after work. Be careful however, of becoming involved in gossip or office politics and make sure your behaviour is professional at all times.
- Be aware of issues such as sexual harassment and discrimination in the workplace. You do not have to tolerate this but should report such instances to your supervisor.
- Take the initiative. Do not always wait to be asked to do a task. Comments like 'That's not my job' or 'Why should I?' indicate a poor attitude to work.
- Show some interest in advancement. Look for opportunities to do more difficult tasks once you have mastered your own, or to take on more responsibilities.
- Give yourself time. Do not make any hasty decisions to quit until you have given your new job a fair trial.
- You need to have balance in your social life and work life. Eating well and getting plenty of regular exercise will help you to remain fit and healthy and ready for work.



In small groups, discuss experiences people you know have had when they began a new job. Make a list of the most common experiences or situations.

Activities

- 1 What are the different types of work places? Give examples.
- 2 What would be the advantages of working from home rather than working in an office? Who would this appeal to? Why?
- 3 Match the following jobs with their usual workplaces.
Workplaces: office, National Park, on the road, restaurant, home, university, hospital, building site, farm, golf course, clothing store, factory
Jobs:

a landscape gardener	d dressmaker	g builder's labourer	j truck driver
b filing clerk	e farm labourer	h lecturer	k park ranger
c shop assistant	f toolmaker	i waitress	l nurse
- 4 Serge has started a new job. At the end of his first week, his fellow workers invite him to the pub for a drink after work. Serge enjoys himself to the point where he gets hopelessly drunk and makes a fool of himself.
 - a** If you were Serge's supervisor at work, what might you say to him and why? What if Serge's behaviour at work showed that he was affected by his drinking? Should he be given another chance? What if he repeated his behaviour?
 - b** If you were Serge and you really wanted this job, what steps would you take?
 - c** Is there a difference between acceptable behaviour at work and acceptable behaviour away from the workplace? Explain.
 - d** Is there a link between behaviour at work and behaviour away from work? Explain, giving examples.
- 4 Explain why it is important to become familiar with your workplace when you start a new job.
- 5 Indicate whether you believe the following statements are true or false.
 - a** Making mistakes in your job can be a good thing.
 - b** Showing initiative in your job should be discouraged.
 - c** Arriving late for work regularly is OK as long as you apologise each time.
 - d** You should always act professionally in your job.
 - e** Gossiping about work mates is really OK as it is fun and helps to pass the time.
- 6 Kwan has started a new job and has made good friends with Jack. Kwan finds that Jack keeps telling him all the office gossip and scandal. Kwan feels rather embarrassed about the things he hears about his fellow workers.
 - a** What is your view of Jack's behaviour?
 - b** What would you do if you were Kwan?
 - c** How might Jack's behaviour backfire on him?
- 7 Kate has started a new job in an office, but after two weeks she decides she doesn't like it. She feels she has less time for fun and spending time with her friends and the job is too difficult and boring.
 - a** What would be your advice to Kate? Why?
 - b** Would your advice be the same if you were one of Kate's friends and you were unemployed? Explain.
 - c** Assuming Kate decides to stick with the job, how long do you think she should allow before making another decision whether to quit or not?
 - d** What circumstances might persuade Kate to stay in the job?

2 Payment for work

There are many forms of payment made to people who work. Some people work for an employer and receive wages or salaries, while others are self-employed.

Wages and salaries

Wages are calculated on an hourly basis. A wage earner may be offered overtime, which is more hours than the normal working day, and for these hours receives higher hourly rates called penalty rates.

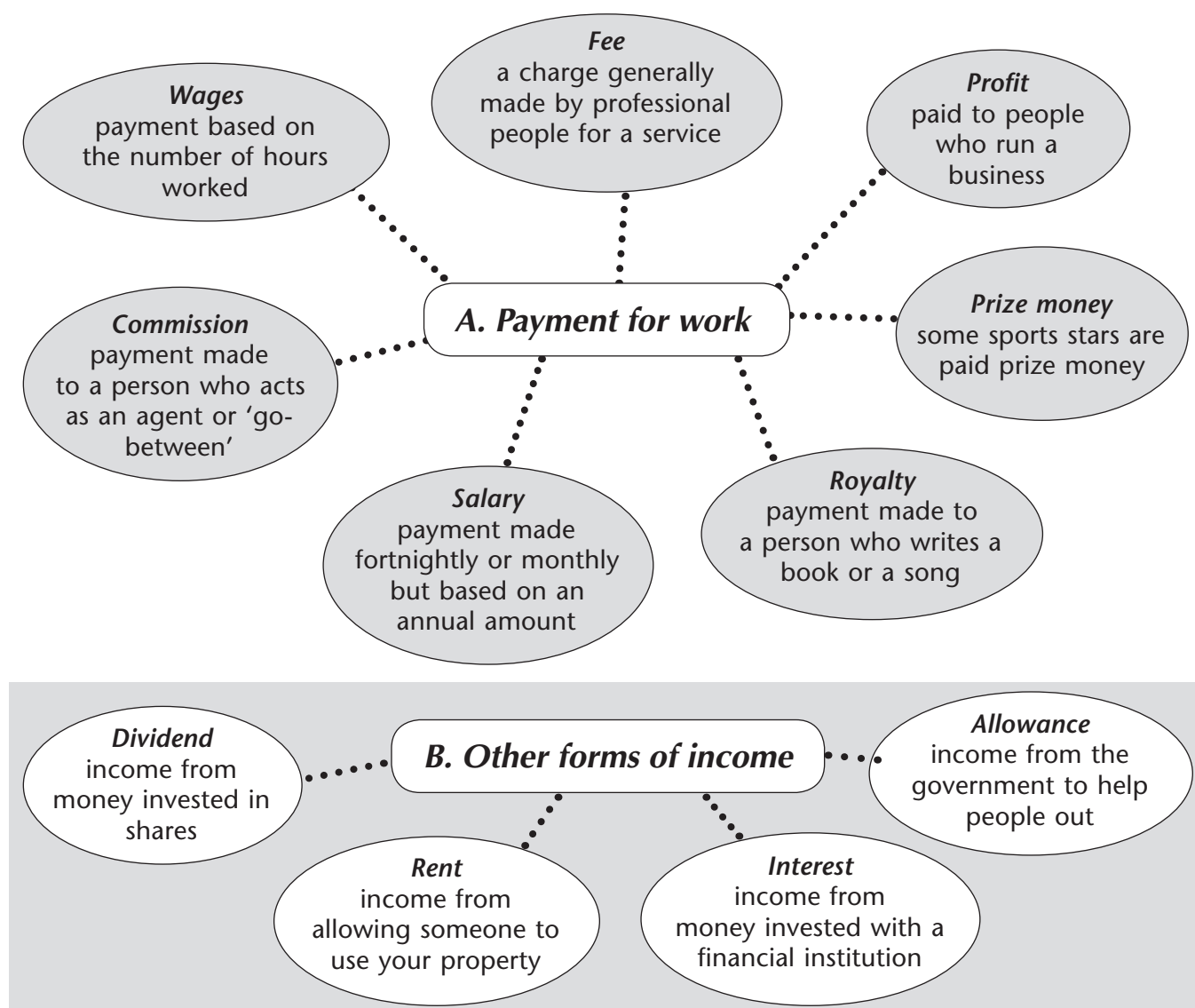
Salaries are calculated on an annual basis even though the payment may be made in fortnightly or monthly instalments. A salaried worker has a job description and is expected to complete certain tasks during the day but is not entitled to overtime or penalty rates. Sometimes salaried workers may be expected to work extra hours to complete a particular task. The annual salary takes all this into account.

Other incomes

People can also earn an income, not through any direct work but by using their money or their property. Their income may consist of interest, dividends or rent.

There are also people who receive an income, usually from the government, to assist them with their living expenses. This form of income is called an allowance.

Incomes and payments



Activities

- 1 Match the income types to the following situations: *wages, fees, salary, royalties, commission, interest, dividend, profit, rent, allowance*.
 - a Kevin works for the local council. He is paid on a weekly basis. He receives _____.
 - b Hussein is an accountant and is paid on a yearly basis. He receives a _____.
 - c John has a house which he lets out to people. He receives _____.
 - d Angela is a doctor and charges _____ for her services.
 - e Ahmed has shares in three different companies. Each year he receives a _____ from these companies.
 - f Jason is a musician. He has been asked by a symphony orchestra to write a fanfare for the Commonwealth Games. He is going to be paid a _____.
 - g Tran writes novels. He expects to receive _____ for his work.
 - h Fred is retired but has invested his retirement money in a bank. He regularly receives _____.
 - i Elena is a sole trader who runs a dry cleaning business. She hopes to make a _____.
 - j Mitchell is unemployed but is registered with Centrelink. His _____ helps him to survive.
- 2 What are the differences between wages and salaries?
- 3 Zita is paid \$20 an hour as an electrician. Her normal working day is 8 hours.
 - a How much does Zita earn in wages each week if she works a 5-day week?
 - b Zita is paid fortnightly. Her boss takes out \$50 in tax each fortnight. What is Zita's fortnightly net (take home) pay?
 - c One week Zita is asked to work 3 hours overtime at the penalty rate of \$30 per hour. What are the gross (or total) wages for that week?
- 4 Which of the following is not an allowance paid by the government?
Disability pension, Child care benefit, Abstudy, Newstart allowance, Tax return, Age pension
- 5 Jessica works for a famous film star. She arranges the film star's daily schedule which includes interviews, and she talks to film producers about future work. Complete the following sentence:
Jessica is an _____ and receives a _____ for this work.
- 6 Kel is an author. He receives a royalty for his writing. What would determine the amount he receives?
- 7 Why do some doctors and dentists charge higher fees than others?
- 8 What is meant by the term 'Schedule of Fees'? Give an example of the schedule of fees for:
 - a a solicitor
 - b a dentist
- 9 Why do you think the salaries of some workers are much higher than others?
- 10 Do all people who work get paid? Explain.



Some highly skilled sportspeople earn prize money. Other people receive prize money as a 'one-off' payment (such as Tattsлото winners). Prize money for the Big Brother TV show is \$1 million. Discuss some of the people you know who receive prize money as a form of income. Do you believe they get paid too much? Record your ideas on a large sheet of paper.

3 Changing work patterns.....

Many changes have taken place in the workplace and in workplace arrangements in the past twenty years. The most common of these changes include:

- a greater variety of jobs available
- greater use of technology, especially computers and telecommunications equipment
- gradual reduction in unskilled work
- changing gender roles as more women become involved in professional occupations such as doctors, lawyers, company directors
- more flexible work arrangements such as flexi-time, rostered days off, and people choosing to work at home or to work part-time
- an increase in casual and contract work
- a greater number of job changes in a person's working life

In the past, people tended to have a job for life. In today's workplace this is less common and people can be expected to have quite a number of job changes throughout their working life. One case in point is Sonia Orchard.

Case study: Sonia Orchard

When Sonia Orchard graduated from high school, her main interests were world peace and feeding Africa. 'At the same time I was well aware they were kind of difficult things to study for,' says Orchard, now 35. 'There was no diploma in world peace at the time.'

Instead, she enrolled in law. Then switched to arts (majoring in literature and classical studies). Then did a short course in food preparation at Melbourne hospitality TAFE, William Angliss. In the next five years, she travelled through Europe, Africa, the US and the Caribbean, working as everything from an au pair to a dive instructor. She came back to Australia and worked as an environmental scientist in the Northern Territory (having also completed a science degree). Then she returned to Melbourne, enrolled in yet another course, a TAFE professional writing and editing diploma at RMIT University and wrote a non fiction novel, *Something More Wonderful*, about the death of her best friend from cancer. These days, she is working on her second novel and supports herself teaching writing and piano. (She also managed an Associate Music Australia diploma at the Victorian College of the Arts along the way.)

'Theres that thing: I don't know how I found myself here,' she laughs. 'But I think you're constantly making small choices, based on what you believe in and what's important at the time, that lead you in a certain direction.'

Extract from article:

The Itch to Switch By Melinda Houston. *Sunday Life Magazine, Sun Herald* 16 April 2006

Of course, not everyone will have the same dramatic changes as Sonia Orchard. However, in today's workplace employees change jobs, companies and careers sometimes every few years. Now there is rarely such a thing as a job for life. Our parents and grandparents were often happy to stay put in one job until retirement. It was seen as secure and a way to pay off a mortgage. Employees today do not want a job for life and employers rarely offer it. Sometimes employers will put workers off and then re-employ them on a casual basis or on contract. Some companies encourage their workers to move from job to job within the company structure or even to leave the company, work for someone else and then return.

Workers may decide to take time off and travel extensively overseas. Some take parental leave to help raise children. Whatever the reason or the motivation, the important thing is to return to the workplace refreshed and with a broader range of experiences.



In groups, discuss the statement: 'There is no such thing as a job for life'.

Activities

- 1 Why do you think there is a greater variety of jobs available today than twenty years ago?
- 2 Give two examples of jobs today that would not have existed thirty years ago.
- 3 Word processors replaced typewriters many years ago. What advantages are there in having word processors rather than typewriters?
- 4 In today's workplace, what are the advantages of the following?
 - a emails b mobile phones c laptops
 - d hand-held wireless devices (such as Blackberries) providing Internet/email communication
- 5 Why has there been a gradual reduction in unskilled work? What does this mean for school-leavers?
- 6 What is meant by 'changing gender roles'? What evidence is there of changing gender roles in the workplace today?
- 7 Using examples, explain what is meant by:
 - a flexi-time b rostered day off
- 8 Why might a company prefer its workers to work on a casual basis or under contract? What are the possible advantages or disadvantages of this arrangement for employees?
- 9 Review the case study of Sonia Orchard.
 - a What were Sonia Orchard's main interests when she left school?
 - b Why were these interests not practical as far as finding work was concerned?
 - c What tertiary studies did she pursue over her career? Do you think these studies were helpful? Explain.
 - d Why do you think she decided to travel overseas? How did this help her to gain experience?
 - e Imagine Sonia is writing a resumé to apply for a job. Given her varied experiences and educational background, write a list of ten points that describe the less obvious skills she may have gained since leaving school.
 - f Do you think that Sonia will make any more career changes during her working life? Give reasons to support your opinion.
- 10 Dimi Ramgoolan worked in a high pressure environment on the foreign exchange desk of a large city bank. He was under constant pressure to perform and make money for the bank by buying and selling foreign exchange. He and his wife, who worked part-time as a consultant in IT, had three children under six years of age. What choices do Dimi and his wife have in relation to work vs. home duties? What would you advise him to do and why?
- 11 Tania and her friend Effie have just left school and each have gained a place at university. They discussed the possibility of deferring their university studies and travelling overseas for twelve months.
 - a What might be the advantages of deferring and travelling?
 - b When people do this, they call it a 'gap year'. Why is it called this?
 - c What are the potential disadvantages of deferring and travelling?
 - d What other options do the two girls have?
 - e What is your opinion? Would you pursue this option? Explain.
- 12 You are talking to your grandfather and he says, 'When I was young you had a job and you stuck to it until the day you retired. When I retired they gave me a gold watch!' What is your response to your grandfather's comments? How do you explain to him that things are different today?

4 Permanent or casual/full or part-time

There are many different working arrangements and entitlements for employees in the work force. However, all workers whether they are permanent or casual, work full-time or part-time, have certain rights. These include the right to be paid at least a minimum wage, the right to work in a safe and healthy workplace and the right to compensation if they are injured at work.

What is the difference?

Permanent employees can expect regular, continuing employment, while casual work is more irregular and uncertain. Employers have no obligation to offer continuing work to a casual employee.

Full-time work is regarded as working 35 hours per week or more on average, while part-time work is less than 35 hours per week, according to the Australian Bureau of Statistics.

Note that not all part-time workers are casual and not all full-time workers are permanent. There are many employees who have permanent part-time working arrangements. Equally, many casual employees work 35 hours or more in a working week.



Why do some people work part-time?

- They may be caring for young children at home.
- They may have other jobs, hobbies or interests.
- They may have a personal preference to work part-time.
- They may be financially secure and do not need the money.
- They may have a job-sharing arrangement with another worker.
- There may be no full-time work available for them.

Why do some people prefer casual work?

- They may prefer the flexibility of working on a casual basis.
- They may not wish to commit to a permanent position.
- They may have other commitments.

Labour force status. Employed persons '000				
	Full-time		Part-time	
	Males	Females	Males	Females
February 1993	2668	1379	143	751
February 2006	4718	2454	821	2061
Source: Australian Bureau of Statistics				

Some employers may prefer to hire casual rather than permanent workers, as it may reduce their costs. For example, casual workers do not get all the entitlements (such as paid sick leave and annual leave) that permanent workers do. There is also an increasing trend for employers to prefer to hire workers under a contract rather than as permanent employees. There are many cases of employees who retire from their permanent positions only to be re-employed in the same or a similar role under contract. In these cases, the contract generally specifies a set of tasks to be completed for a set fee.

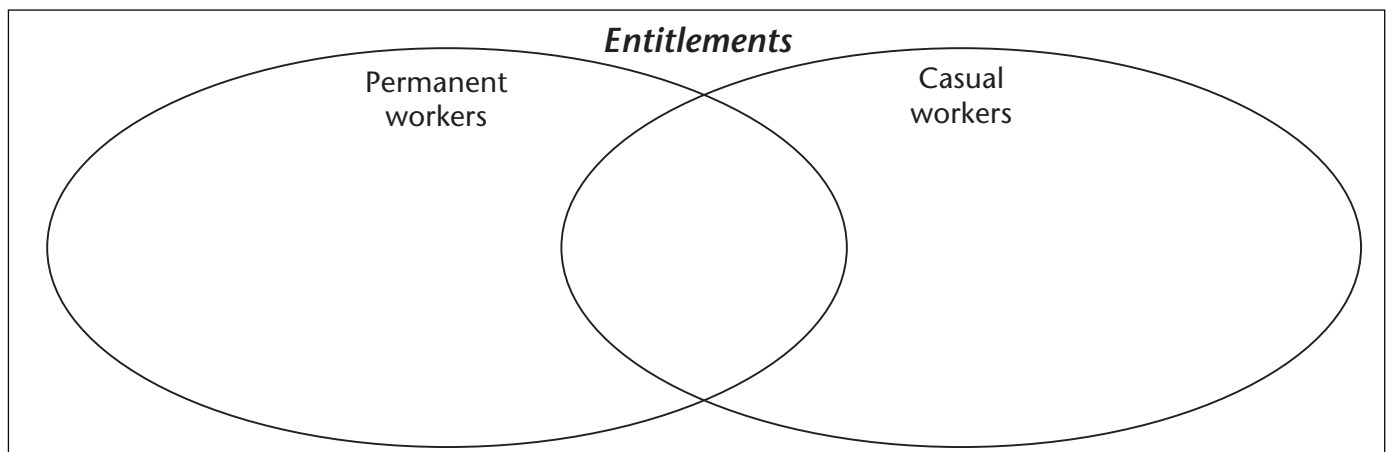
Activities

- 1 What message does the cartoon on the previous page convey about permanent and casual work? Is it a true reflection of reality? Explain.
- 2 Study the statistics on full-time and part-time employment between 1993 and 2006 in the table on the previous page.
 - a What do you notice about the change in the number of females in the workforce?
 - b What do you notice about the percentage of women in part-time employment in 1993 and in 2006?
 - c Calculate the percentage of workers in part-time employment in 1993 and in 2006. What do you notice about the difference? What does this illustrate?
 - d What is the difference in the total workforce between the two years? What factors might cause these changes?
- 3 Name two jobs where employees have permanent status but work part-time.
- 4 Name two jobs where employees are casuals yet work full-time.
- 5 Indira is a qualified teacher. She is now married with three young children all under 5 years of age. She wants to return to the workforce. What choices do you think she has and why? Would these choices differ if she were a highly skilled IT consultant?
- 6 Joe is 58 years old. He has been working as a schoolteacher since he was 20. He now finds that his health is suffering from the stress of the job. What options do you think Joe has available to him? Explain the advantages and disadvantages of these options.
- 7 Kwan has been working as an engineer for a large mining company for the past 30 years. The company has decided to dismiss him as an employee and then re-hire him on contract. Why might a company do this? What are the advantages or disadvantages as far as Kwan is concerned?
- 8 Jody is a university student who works in a juice bar in the city. Her friend Nina works in a solicitors' office, also in the city.
 - a Would Jody be more likely to be a permanent or a casual worker? Why?
 - b What about Nina's status? Would it be different?
 - c Which of the two would be more likely to work full-time? Why?



Using the Venn diagram (below), show the entitlements available to permanent workers and to casual workers. Show entitlements they both have where the circles overlap.

Write two or three paragraphs on the topic, 'The rights of workers'.



5 Working conditions.....

Working conditions today are very varied but there have certainly been great improvements since the 1850s. Some of the rules which may have applied to the clerical staff of a typical major warehouse company at that time are listed below.

- Hours of work: 7 am to 6 pm
- Daily prayers held each morning, which the staff were expected to attend
- Staff expected to dress in 'sober colours'
- Permission to be obtained for visits to the toilet
- Talking not allowed during business hours
- Staff permitted to eat food between 11.30 am and 12 noon, but not permitted to cease work.
- Members of staff expected to provide their own pens
- Junior staff required to clean the office after hours



Working conditions today:

1. Hours of work

- A 35-hour working week is regarded as full-time work.
- There has been a steady growth in casual and part-time work.
- There has been a marked increase in the number of hours being worked by full-time workers.

2. Benefits and entitlements

- Leave generally consists of: annual (or holiday) leave, sick leave, family leave (maternity and paternity leave), long service leave, special leave (for example, to attend funerals), leave without pay.
- In August 2005, 76% of employees were provided with one or more types of paid leave.
- Full-time employees were more likely than part-time employees to have leave entitlements (87% compared with 41%).
- Entitlements include fringe benefits (rewards for employees, income in kind), holiday leave loading, termination payouts and rights relating to unfair dismissal.
- Fringe benefits typically include a company car, children's education expenses, entertainment allowances and assistance with paying housing loans. These are often associated with a 'salary package'.
- Employers are required to provide superannuation benefits of 9% of wages for their employees' retirement. Employees can also contribute money from their pay towards their own retirement.

STRANGE BUT TRUE!

- ☞ Before 1850, when workers began to organise themselves into Unions, building workers often worked 60 hours a week. In 1947 the trade unions won a campaign for a 40-hour working week.

Activities

- 1 Why do you think many full-time workers are now working more than the 35-hour week?
- 2 Make a list of all the types of paid leave available to workers and describe the nature of each type.
- 3 Read the list of workplace rules which typically applied in the 1850s.
 - a How did the hours of work compare with those operating today? Give specific examples.
 - b Why do you think daily prayers were said each day? Why wouldn't this happen today?
 - c How have dress rules in the workplace changed over the years?
 - d Do you think there should be dress standards in the workplace? Explain how these may vary according to the occupations of the workers.
 - e List some of the other rules operating in the 1850s which do not apply today. Explain why they are no longer acceptable rules.
 - f Why are cleaners now employed to clean offices instead of expecting the clerical staff to do this?
 - g Are there still cases where employees must do cleaning? Explain.
- 4 Why might a worker be granted leave without pay?
- 5 What is superannuation? Is it a benefit or an entitlement, or both? Who pays it?
- 6 What is meant by the following terms?
 - a paternity leave
 - b fringe benefits
 - c salary package
- 7 What statistical evidence is there to show that full-time workers are more likely to have access to paid leave than part-time workers?
- 8 Jody is a university student who works in a juice bar in the city. Her friend Nina, a university law graduate, works in a solicitors' office, also in the city.
What differences are there likely to be in their working conditions? Mention things like hours of work, leave entitlements and any other entitlements or benefits.



In small groups, discuss the topic of working conditions that exist in most workplaces today. Construct a mind map based on these discussions.

Find out about other important industrial relations reforms over the past 100 years in Australia.

Choose three different countries, and draw up a chart comparing standard working conditions and entitlements in each country with the current working conditions and entitlements in Australia.

Look through the employment section of a newspaper. Find at least three advertisements that refer to different types of working conditions. Write a list of advantages and disadvantages for each one, then state which one you would prefer and why.

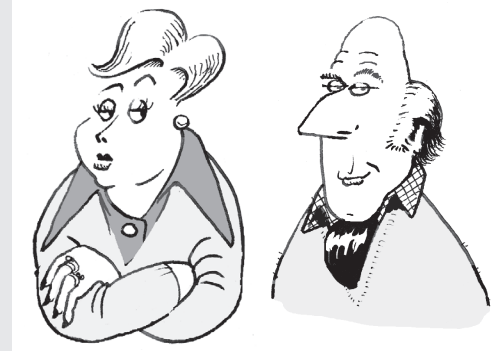
6 Sexual harassment.....

Sexual harassment in the workplace is any behaviour of a sexual nature which is unwelcome to the person concerned. Although sexual harassment is unlawful under the Sex discrimination Act of 1984, it is still a common occurrence in Australian workplaces.

Scott worked as a receptionist for a law firm. **Morag**, one of the lawyers, would often send SMS text messages and pictures of a sexual nature to his mobile phone. She would also tell him dirty jokes. Scott was unsure how to react to these jokes as he did not want to appear too narrow-minded, but he sometimes felt uncomfortable about them. Morag also showed Scott some pictures of pin-up men hanging on her office wall. At no time did Morag touch Scott inappropriately, nor did she ever ask him out on a date.



Georgia worked on the cosmetics counter of a large department store. Her boss, **Alex** was constantly staring at her and making comments about her body. He also asked her to put on some perfume so he could check it out by kissing her neck. Georgia did not like this sort of behaviour and she told him so. He ignored her objections and then began touching her inappropriately and brushing up against her. When she objected again he called her into his office and told her she was being transferred to the dispatch office at the back of the store.



Emily and **Ming** started work together in a large insurance office. Ming found Emily to be an attractive and interesting person and he told her so. He would often make complimentary remarks about her appearance. Emily did not mind this and in fact, felt rather flattered. After a while Ming asked Emily out to dinner. She accepted and so began an office romance.

Some facts:

- 28% of women and 7% of men in Australia have experienced sexual harassment in some form in the workplace.
- Sexual harassment does not have to be physical in nature. It can include suggestive comments or jokes, intrusive questions about a person's private life or repeated, unwanted invitations to go out on dates.
- Physical sexual harassment occurred in 62% of cases while non-physical sexual harassment accounted for 38%.

What can be done?

Any worker, whether male or female, can and should report cases of sexual harassment in the first instance to their manager, supervisor or employer. If there is no satisfactory outcome from this, a worker may report the matter to the Human Rights and Equal Opportunity Commission (HREOC).

Activities

- 1 Why do you think sexual harassment is unlawful?
- 2 How is sexual harassment different from flirting among work colleagues?
- 3 Can sexual harassment be non-physical? Explain.
- 4 Review the stories of Emily and Ming, Georgia and Scott.
 - a Was there any sexual harassment in Ming's behaviour? Explain.
 - b What would have to happen for it to be sexual harassment?
 - c Let us assume that the romantic relationship between Ming and Emily ends. They have a big argument. Emily then goes to her supervisor to report sexual harassment against Ming. If you were the supervisor, what would your attitude be, and what would you do about it?
 - d What should Georgia do about her situation?
 - e If Georgia's employer tells her she is over-reacting and dismisses her case, what can she do?
 - f Do you believe that Scott was sexually harassed? Give reasons.
 - g Let us assume that Scott does report Morag to his employer. Morag is called in and when confronted with her actions, proceeds to sincerely apologise to Scott. What do you think should happen then?
 - h If you were Scott's supervisor what action would you take?
 - i What would you do if Morag continued with her former behaviour?
 - j Let us assume that Scott decides to resign. As his supervisor, what is your attitude? What action could be taken against Morag?
- 5 What is the percentage of Australian women and men who have experienced some form of sexual harassment in the workplace? Do you think these are high percentages? Explain.
- 6 Make a list of the different types of behaviour which can be classed as sexual harassment.



In groups, take each of the three case studies and write a brief sequel to their stories. Each member of the group could propose a different ending for each story.

Find out more about the Human Rights and Equal Opportunity Commission and the statistical data related to sexual harassment in the workplace. Make a brief summary of this statistical information.

7 Equal opportunity

Discrimination is defined as: *Unfair treatment of a person or group on the basis of prejudice.*

Society has come to realise that some groups of workers in the past have been treated unfairly. Equal opportunity is an important principle which operates in workplaces today and is now supported by legislation. In workplaces throughout Australia, it is against the law for any employee to be discriminated against by being refused employment or promotion, given less favourable conditions of employment or being dismissed because of their:

- sex
- pregnancy
- race (colour, nationality, ethnic background)
- marital status
- sexual orientation
- disability (physical or intellectual)
- age
- religion.

This law applies to all employees, including those on probation, apprentices, trainees, whether they are casual, permanent, part-time or full-time.

The Human Rights and Equal Opportunity Commission is a national independent statutory organisation established to promote and protect human rights in Australia. One of its main functions is to investigate and conciliate complaints of discrimination lodged under these laws:

- The Racial Discrimination Act
- The Sex Discrimination Act
- The Disability Discrimination Act
- The Age Discrimination Act.

The Commission also investigates and conciliates complaints of discrimination lodged under the Human Rights and Equal Opportunity Commission Act. Under this law you can make a complaint if you think you have been discriminated against in your employment on any grounds. The complaints process is private, confidential and free.

Sex discrimination means being treated less favourably than someone else because of your sex or marital status or because you are pregnant.

Sexual harassment is a type of sex discrimination.

It is unlawful to dismiss a person from employment on the ground of family responsibilities such as care of children.

It is against the law for an employer to discriminate against any employees on the basis of race, colour, national or ethnic origin.

The Human Rights and Equal Opportunity Commission inquires into complaints of racial hatred. Racial hatred is defined as a public act which is likely to offend, insult, humiliate or intimidate a person or group and is based on race, colour, national or ethnic origin.

Employers are obliged to make reasonable arrangements to assist a person with a disability to carry out the required tasks of his or her job.

Age discrimination is not unlawful if a person is unable to carry out the required tasks because of his or her age.

The law provides for positive age discrimination. This means helping people who experience a disadvantage because of their particular age.

Activities

- 1 Complete the following sentences. It is unlawful for any employer to discriminate against an employee on the basis of their _____, their _____, their _____ or their _____. The four Acts of Parliament which relate to this are the _____ Act, the _____ Act, the _____ Act and the _____ Act. These Acts apply to all employees, whether they have _____ or _____ status and whether they work _____ or _____.
- 2 What do the letters HREOC stand for? What does this organisation do?
- 3 What is sex discrimination? Give an example of how it might happen in the workplace.
- 4 Why do you think the law prevents employers from discriminating against people with disabilities?
- 5 You employ Jane, who has a disability. She has great difficulty in concentrating on a task for too long. You give her a task to do but you find that she can't manage it because of her disability. What do you do?
- 6 Maria works as a legal secretary and is regarded as being very efficient at her job. One day she informs her boss that she is pregnant. A week later her boss terminates her employment.
 - a Has Maria's boss acted lawfully? Explain.
 - b What should Maria do in the first instance?
 - c What action can Maria take if her initial approaches are unsuccessful?
 - d What options might be available to Maria's employer in this situation?
- 7 Tran is employed as a carpenter on a building site. His supervisor regularly makes nasty comments about Tran's ethnic origin. Tran is a good worker but he finds he is given all the unpleasant work to do while other workers seem to get preferential treatment.
 - a Is Tran being discriminated against at work? Explain.
 - b Could Tran's supervisor be charged, and if so under which Act of Parliament?
 - c What action should Tran take if this situation continues?
 - d You have been asked by Tran to write a letter formally complaining about his treatment. Write the letter for Tran, describing the treatment he is receiving. Give details of specific behaviour, and comments made to Tran at his workplace.
- 8 Sean is 65 years old and works as a sports commentator for a television network. He has had a successful career lasting over 30 years. One day he receives a phone call telling him his services are no longer required. He is told that the network is looking for a new image.
 - a Is Sean being discriminated against? Explain.
 - b Does the television network have any legal rights in this case? Explain.
 - c What might the network offer Sean?
- 9 Fabio is a very good accountant for a major company. One day Tyrone, his employer, discovers that Fabio is gay. Tyrone instantly dismisses Fabio and tells him bluntly that having gay employees is not good for the company's image.
 - a Was Fabio dismissed unfairly? Explain.
 - b What options does Fabio have?
 - c Under which Act of Parliament could Fabio's case be pursued?



Discuss the theme of equal opportunity as a class group. Provide specific examples of discrimination in the workplace from your own knowledge or personal experiences. Make a list of the most common forms of discrimination.

8 Workplace agreements.....

Workers are generally employed on the basis of an employment contract. This sets out the pay and working conditions agreed to between employers and employees. Employment contracts may be either awards or workplace agreements.

What is an award?

An award is the minimum rate of pay and working conditions for a particular job. It is set by an industrial court such as the Australian Industrial Relations Commission. Awards are generally negotiated by trade unions for relatively large numbers of workers on an industry basis, e.g. the mining industry or the hospitality industry.

What is a workplace agreement?

A workplace agreement is an agreement between an individual employee and an employer in their specific workplace situation. It aims to provide more consultation and greater flexibility in the workplace.

History of employment contracts

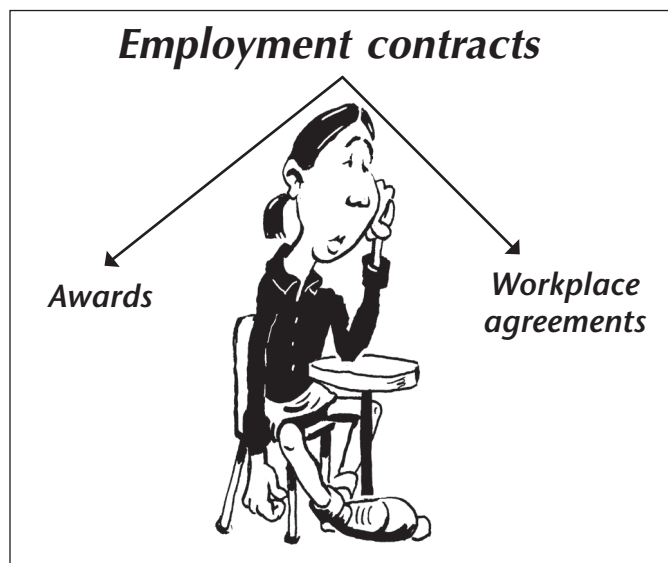
Employment contracts are governed by Australian Government legislation which sets out how agreements can be made. To understand the current situation with regard to workplace relations, it is important to consider the most significant developments in recent history. Some of these developments were:

The Conciliation & Arbitration Act of 1904 established the Award System. It had extensive powers to prevent and settle industrial disputes by conciliation and arbitration. In 1907 the concept of a basic wage was adopted. Some workers were covered by state awards and some by federal awards.

The Industrial Relations Act of 1988 established the Australian Industrial Relations Commission (AIRC). Its aim was to conciliate (resolving disputes by consultations and compulsory conferences), and to compulsorily arbitrate (settle disputes) where necessary. Each state also had its own industrial commission to cover workers under state awards.

Equal Pay Case. In 1993, the AIRC was given the power to make orders to ensure equal pay for work of equal value for both men and women. Female workers once received little more than half the pay that male workers received.

Major changes often come with a change of government. The *1996 Workplace Relations Act* introduced Australian Workplace Agreements (AWAs). The AIRC lost its authority when a new body called the Employment Advocate was established. Awards could still be negotiated with the trade unions but the intention was to simplify them and reduce them in number.



Useful definitions

Basic wage: pay which was considered enough for a family to live in reasonable comfort. The principle of the basic wage was adopted for all future wage fixing cases.

Consultation: process of two parties talking together about issues.

Conciliation: a process which attempts to resolve disputes by compromise or voluntary agreement.

Arbitration: making a decision or a judgement on an industrial dispute.

Compulsory conference: an industrial court orders a meeting between two parties in dispute.

The *Work Choices Act*, passed in 2006, brought major changes, amending the former Workplace Relations Act of 1996. The following fundamental changes were proposed.

- Encouraging workplace agreements without the intervention of trade unions
- Establishing the Australian Fair Pay Commission to set and review federal minimum wages
- Prohibiting some working conditions from being included in workplace agreements
- Removing the Australian Industrial Relations Commission's powers to conciliate and arbitrate disputes or create new awards
- Retaining unfair dismissal laws but confining their application to businesses with more than 100 employees
- Overriding state industrial relations laws, with a view to creating a national workplace relations system

Activities

- 1 Explain the difference between an award and a workplace agreement.
- 2 Explain the difference between the words 'conciliation' and 'arbitration'.
- 3 What did the Conciliation and Arbitration Act of 1904 establish?
- 4 Why do you think some workers were covered by state awards and others by federal awards?
- 5 The basic wage was determined to be 'that payable to an adult male worker supporting a non-working wife and two children'.
 - a Why do you think the basic wage concept was introduced?
 - b Is the basic wage concept still relevant today? Explain.
 - c What could happen if there was no basic or minimum wage?
- 6 What was the purpose of the AIRC?
- 7 What major changes occurred with the Workplace Relations Act of 1996?
- 8 In your own words, describe the changes that were made in 2006 to the Workplace Relations Act.
- 9 What effects do you think this will have on:
 - a the trade unions?
 - b young workers?
- 10 Do you think employers will benefit from the most recent changes? Explain.



Find out more information about 'Work Choices', in particular the impacts of the 2006 legislation on different individuals or groups.

Hold a class discussion on current industrial relations issues. Check the daily newspapers or the web for the latest developments.

9 Unemployment.....

Definitions

A person is considered to be **unemployed** if they are:

- not working
- available for work
- taking active steps to find work.

A person is considered to be **employed** if they work for one hour or more for pay, profit, commission or other form of payment.

The **labour force** includes all persons who are employed and unemployed.

The **participation** rate is the percentage of the population over 15 years who are in the labour force.

Why are people unemployed?

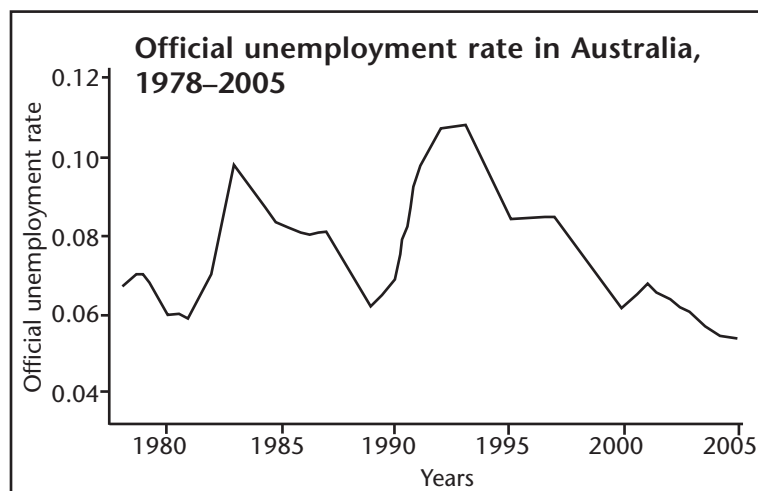
- Some may be in the process of changing jobs.
- They may be unsuccessful in finding a job.
- Some may have jobs which are seasonal with no work available in the off season.
- In an economic downturn, unemployment levels may be high.
- People with low skills or no job training find it more difficult to find a job.
- Some people may need to consider retraining.
- Young people may have difficulty finding a job because of their lack of experience.
- Some people are fussy about the jobs they are prepared to do.

Youth unemployment

Many young people cannot find jobs because they have no experience. Yet how can they gain experience if no one will employ them? This is the dilemma faced by many young people and is a major reason why youth unemployment rates are higher than unemployment rates in the general community.

Labour force, Australia, May 2006

Trend	Apr 2006	May 2006	Apr 06 to May 06	May 05 to May 06
Employed persons ('000)	10 099.1	10 114.1	15.0	1.2%
Unemployed persons ('000)	537.0	532.6	-4.3	-0.3%
Unemployment rate (%)	5.0	5.0	0.0 pts	-0.1 pts
Participation rate (%)	64.4	64.5	0.0 pts	-0.1 pts



Devi had a weekend job selling ice creams. When a new owner took over the business he demanded that Devi sign a new work contract. She refused as she realised that her pay was going to be cut. Not only was her hourly rate reduced, but she found she would not be paid penalty rates for working on Sundays. Her refusal to sign meant that she lost her job. She is now unemployed.

Leo and **Russell** worked as coal miners in a remote part of the country. Unfortunately, the mining company they worked for ran into financial difficulties because of falling coal prices. The mine was forced to close and as a result Leo and Russell are unemployed.

Sef was an early school leaver. He looked for a job but couldn't find one. Wherever he went he was told that he had no skills and no experience. He is unemployed.

Activities

- 1 Is a person who is not actively looking for a job considered to be unemployed? Explain.
- 2 Explain what is meant by the participation rate. What factors would cause it to change?
- 3 Make a list of the reasons for unemployment in the workforce.
- 4 Why is youth unemployment such a problem?
- 5 What do you believe are the attitudes of employers to young workers? Give examples from your personal knowledge or experience.
- 6 Review the story of Devi.
 - a How did Devi become unemployed?
 - b Why do you think Devi refused to sign the new work contract?
 - c What options did Devi then have?
 - d What is your view of Devi's situation?
- 7 Review the story of Leo and Russell.
 - a What caused them to become unemployed?
 - b What could they do about their situation?
 - c What would you do if you were in their situation?
- 8 Read the story of Sef.
 - a Why was Sef unemployed?
 - b What could he do about his situation in the short term, and also in the long term?
 - c How is Sef's story related to the problems of youth unemployment?
- 9 Write your own story of a person who is unemployed. Your story should explain the circumstances and therefore the reasons for their unemployed status.
- 10 Study the table showing labour force statistics for April–May 2006.
 - a How many unemployed persons were there in May 2006?
 - b Compared to the previous month, what was the actual difference?
 - c What was the unemployment rate in May 2006?
 - d What was the participation rate in May 2006?
 - e What has happened to the participation rate over the past year?
- 11 Study the graph showing unemployment in Australia since 1978.
 - a In which year was unemployment at its highest level?
 - b Suggest a possible cause for this high level of unemployment.
 - c Why is it important to study unemployment rates in Australia?
- 12 Unemployment rates are higher in regional and rural areas of Australia than they are in the large cities. Explain some possible causes for this.
- 13 How does long-term unemployment affect **a** individuals **b** their families?
- 14 How does the government help people who are unemployed? Check the Centrelink website to help you answer this question.
- 15 What can the government do for the long-term unemployed?
- 16 What effect would a growing Australian economy have on unemployment?



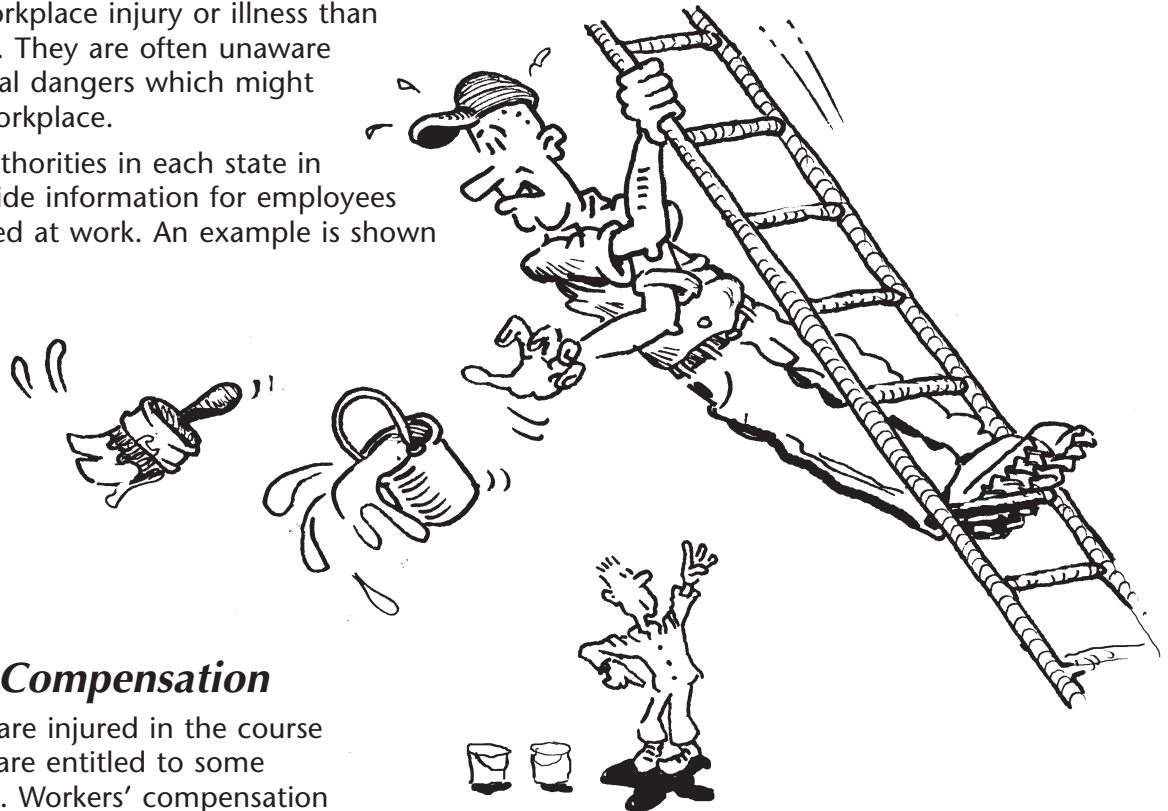
*In small groups, discuss these statements:
 'Take this job or be unemployed'.
 'Employers complain that young people don't want to work'.
 'Young people complain about poor pay and working conditions'.*

10 Workplace protection.....

Under Occupational Health and Safety (OH&S) laws, both employees and employers have responsibility for health and safety in the workplace. Employers have a duty of care to protect the health and the safety of their workers.

New and inexperienced workers are more at risk of a workplace injury or illness than other workers. They are often unaware of the potential dangers which might exist in the workplace.

WorkCover authorities in each state in Australia provide information for employees who are injured at work. An example is shown below right.



Workers' Compensation

Workers who are injured in the course of their work are entitled to some compensation. Workers' compensation generally means payments for loss of earnings as well as medical and hospital bills. All employers must take out a special insurance policy to cover their employees for workers' compensation.

Evelyn worked at a car parts factory which made gear boxes. Her job was on a metal press where she had to press a button to operate the press. One day she accidentally caught her hand in the press, suffering serious injuries. She needed immediate medical treatment and was off work for ten weeks. She reported the incident and submitted a Work Injury Report Form (using her good hand). The company paid her medical bills and arranged a rehabilitation program which involved exercising her hand. She was able to continue working at the factory but was assigned different duties which did not affect her injured hand. Six months later, her hand was fully recovered and she was able to resume her normal work.

If you suffer an injury or illness at work you are protected by workers' compensation.

Here are the steps you should follow:

- 1 Report the incident immediately to your employer, supervisor or OH & S representative.
- 2 If you visit a doctor, ask for a medical certificate.
- 3 Get a copy of a Work Injury Report Form from your employer or from WorkCover.
- 4 Fill in the details in the worker section on the form.
- 5 Give the form to your employer.

Your employer then completes the employer section and submits the form to WorkCover. When the claim has been processed you will receive the necessary medical treatment and rehabilitation to get you back to work as quickly and as safely as possible.

Source: Starting a New Job. WorkCover Corporation of South Australia

Activities

- 1 What do the letters OH & S stand for? Why is this important in the workplace?
- 2 Study the cartoon on the previous page.
 - a What is the nature of the accident depicted in the cartoon?
 - b What precautions should the employee have taken while doing this job?
 - c What advice should the employer have given before asking a worker to perform this task?
 - d What workplace laws or regulations may be necessary to guard against this type of accident?
- 3 Review the boxed text from WorkCover South Australia.
 - a What is the first step a worker should take if injured at work?
 - b Why is a medical certificate important if a visit to the doctor is necessary?
 - c What must the employer do when there is a workplace accident?
 - d What happens when the form is submitted by the injured worker and the employer?
- 4 Review Evelyn's story.
 - a Was Evelyn entitled to compensation? Explain.
 - b What form did this compensation take?
 - c What obligations did the company have in looking after Evelyn prior to her accident?
 - d If Evelyn had been negligent or careless, would she still have been entitled to compensation? Explain.
 - e What would have happened if Evelyn's hand had been permanently damaged and she was unable to return to work at the factory?
- 5 Evelyn's friend Mia worked on a similar press. Mia played netball on the weekends and damaged her hand in a game. Mia decided to claim workers' compensation, saying that she damaged her hand at work.
 - a Can Mia legally do this? Explain.
 - b What could happen if she were found out?
- 6 Some serious work injuries have resulted in huge payouts to permanently injured workers. Is this a problem in relation to the community as a whole? Explain.
- 7 Explain the importance of workplace training.
- 8 Describe a situation when retraining might be necessary or advisable.
- 9 Do you think workers' compensation should cover you for loss of earnings as well as medical expenses? Explain.
- 10 Why do employers have to take out workers' compensation insurance?



Use the Internet Search Engines to find out more information about workers' compensation in your own state. The word 'WorkCover' will help you to search. Write two paragraphs outlining the information you have discovered.

11 Employment relations.....

Anna: Hi, my name is Anna and I am going to be helping you in your new job.

Karina: Thanks Anna, are you going to be like my buddy?

Anna: Yes, you could put it that way. I want you to feel happy at work. I want you to understand that you will be relating to your work colleagues as well as your supervisor. Your own personality and personal skills will be visible to others and you will be judged on them.

Karina: I hope I don't disappoint everyone.

Anna: Don't worry about it. You are bound to make some mistakes but that is a normal part of learning your job. If you approach your job with a positive attitude you will be fine. It is only when people whinge and complain or criticise others that problems can arise.

A work buddy or a mentor

Every worker needs a buddy to lean on; someone to go to for advice; a shoulder to cry on; perhaps a role model; someone to be a supportive friend. Sometimes a more senior colleague can act as a mentor, and take a new employee under their wing, encouraging, advising and maybe helping train a worker for future promotion.

Employer–employee relations

A good relationship with the boss is an important part of maintaining a happy work environment. An understanding of the different roles and duties of people in the workplace is essential for a good working environment. Adopting an 'us and them' mentality to employers or supervisors is unproductive and fruitless.

Office gossip

It can be easy to get caught up in office gossip or politics. Criticising work colleagues behind their backs is in poor taste and regarded as unprofessional. Relaxing after work, having a drink with workmates and having fun is OK but you need to be careful that you do not lose the respect of your work colleagues through irresponsible or inappropriate behaviour.

Office emails

From: Sabina Bartoli, Branch Supervisor
To: Adam Roberts
Sent: Monday 7th August 2006 2.40 pm
Subject: Professional behaviour

I have noticed that you have been rather rude to your work colleagues lately. Swearing at them, abusing them and blaming them for your errors is unprofessional conduct. I would like you to think about this and then we can arrange to have a talk about it. I would like to help but I cannot allow this sort of behaviour to continue as it affects the harmony in the office.

"DID YOU KNOW THAT
AHMED HAS BEEN
TALKING ABOUT ME
BEHIND MY BACK?
I CAN'T BELIEVE..."

"YES, AND DID YOU
SEE THE WAY HE'S
BEEN LOOKING AT
LEILA LATELY?
SOMETHING..."



From: Adam Roberts
To: Sabina Bartoli, Branch Supervisor
Sent: Monday 7th August 4.15 pm
Subject: Re: Professional behaviour

I am very sorry Ms Bartoli, but I have been under a lot of pressure lately, not only at work but also at home. I have a mother who is very ill and needs constant care. I have also just split up with my partner. I guess I have been taking out my frustrations on the people at work. I would be happy to talk to you about my problems and my behaviour. I must also admit that I have been having some trouble understanding some of the tasks I have to perform at work. Perhaps we could meet some time tomorrow?

Activities

- 1 Why do you think behaviour and general appearance at work is important?
- 2 What is meant by the term 'interpersonal skills'? Give three examples.
- 3 What is meant by 'an us and them mentality'?
- 4 Explain the difference between a work buddy and a mentor. Are there some circumstances where they can be the same person? Explain.
- 5 Sung-Lee was asked by her supervisor to be a work buddy for Alice, the girl just starting work. Sung-Lee replied that she was too busy and did not believe in that sort of nonsense.
 - a What is your view of Sung-Lee's attitude? Does she have a point?
 - b If you were Alice, what would you think of Sung-Lee's attitude?
 - c Imagine you are the supervisor. What would you say to Sung-Lee?
 - d Is it better to insist that Sung-Lee take on the job, or find a different work buddy for Alice? Explain.
 - e What would be the benefits of a work buddy relationship from Alice's point of view, and also from Sung-Lee's point of view?
- 6 Study the cartoon on the previous page.
 - a What message is the cartoonist trying to convey?
 - b If you were Ahmed and overheard this conversation, what would you think? What might you do?
- 7 Study the two office emails.
 - a Why did Sabina Bartoli write this email?
 - b Did you think her language was appropriate?
 - c Would it have been better to speak to Adam Roberts directly, rather than sending him an email?
 - d What was your view of Adam Roberts' reply?
 - e Do you think this matter will be resolved? Explain.
 - f Write an email from Ms Bartoli to Adam Roberts arranging the meeting.
 - g Suggest a likely outcome from that meeting.
- 8 Why is the way you use language, whether in emails or in direct conversation, so important in the workplace?



Write a role play script of a workplace conversation between two or three people demonstrating the importance of professional behaviour. You could write two scripts, one showing positive behaviour and the other inappropriate behaviour.

12 Industrial disputes.....

Industrial disputes occur when differences between employees and the employer arise. Some industrial disputes can be quickly and easily solved. A complaint about the state of the staff toilets or lunchroom can be brought to the attention of the employers. They examine the situation and agree to fix the problem. Most of the minor disputes can be solved in this way, by mutual agreement and a 'give and take' attitude by both parties. Reductions in pay rates, especially penalty rates, or cuts in leave entitlements however, are generally more controversial.

A typical dispute might take the following course:

- **Phase 1** The RU E-Tin Restaurant employs 20 people, most of whom work on weekends. The restaurant owners have decided to refuse to pay penalty rates for weekend work. All employees will be forced to take a cut in pay.
- **Phase 2** The employees call a stopwork meeting to discuss the situation. For this meeting they decide to call in a trade union organiser to discuss their options.
- **Phase 3** The trade union organiser addresses the meeting of employees and suggests they take their complaints, as a group, to their employer. If this proves unsuccessful they could decide to go on strike. She explains the types of strikes they have at their disposal, such as a lightning strike which is called quickly, often without trade union approval, a wildcat strike which is not organised by a trade union, a sit-down strike where employees go to work but do nothing, or a rolling strike where there is a succession of strikes at short intervals.
- **Phase 4** Negotiations with the employer fail and so a strike is called. Most employees withdraw their labour. Some however, are not trade union members and do not agree with the strike, and so they decide to return to work. Union members who are on strike then form a picket line at the entrance to the restaurant.
- **Phase 5** Meanwhile, the restaurant owners hear of this proposed strike and decide to lock out the workers and employ members of their own family to run the restaurant.
- **Phase 6** The restaurant owners and the employees meet again to try to resolve the dispute. No agreement is reached.
- **Phase 7** Since this is an industrial dispute, both parties are summoned to appear before an industrial court. The court calls for a compulsory conference between the two parties to try to resolve the dispute. This fails and so the matter is subjected to arbitration.
- **Phase 8** The industrial court orders the employees back to work. Some of them go back to work and accept the reduced pay, while others resign on principle.



Activities

- 1 Match the following terms with the definitions below:
lightning strike, lockout, picket line, arbitration, stopwork meeting, wildcat strike, sit-down strike, compulsory conference, penalty rates, rolling strikes
 - a** A strike that is not union-organised
 - b** An employer refuses to let the employees into the premises
 - c** A formal judgment in an industrial dispute
 - d** A group of striking workers who line up at the entrance to a workplace
 - e** A meeting called to stop work and discuss a dispute
 - f** Employees go to work but do no work
 - g** A meeting called by an industrial court to try to resolve a dispute
 - h** A strike called quickly, possibly without union approval
 - i** Rates of pay which are higher than normal because of weekend work
 - j** A series of strikes over time
- 2 At the restaurant, what was the issue in dispute?
- 3 What was the view of the employees?
- 4 What was the attitude of the restaurant owners? Why might they have taken this attitude?
- 5 What actions were at the disposal of the employees? What actions did they take?
- 6 What did the restaurant owners do in retaliation?
- 7 How was the dispute eventually resolved?
- 8 Who do you think were the winners and the losers in this dispute?
- 9 Suggest how the dispute might have been resolved more amicably.
- 10 Give examples of disputes which are normally easily resolved. Explain why.



Conduct a class role play of a typical industrial dispute. Key players would be employees, the employer, trade union officials and industrial court judge. The role play could be scripted or acted out unrehearsed.

STRANGE BUT TRUE!

- ☞ The first strike by female workers in Australia was in 1827, when convict women employed in a factory went on strike because their tea and sugar rations were stopped. They won the battle!

13 Trade unions.....

What is a trade union?

It is an organisation which represents a group of workers who unite to maintain and improve pay rates and working conditions.

Falling membership

At the beginning of the 20th century, Australia had the most unionised workforce in the world. Although membership rose and fell at different times, over 50% of employees belonged to a union. Today, union membership is less than 25%. There are many reasons for the change, one being the increase in self-employed Australians.

The trade unions have embarked on membership drives aimed at signing up new members as well as retaining existing membership. Over the years, workers have become more critical of unions and want to see some benefit in being a member. The trade unions in turn have begun offering incentives such as discount housing loans, free legal services, travel services, credit cards and health benefits. The main focus of the trade union movement however, is to protect workers' rights.

The trade union movement is also trying to address the falling membership by arranging amalgamations, so that small trade unions join together to form a large super union with more power.

Changes to the Workplace Relations Act in 2006 resulted in increased interest by employees in joining a trade union. This was indicated by a 4% increase in membership from August 2004 to August 2005 from 1 838 365 to 1 911 900.

The main union body is the Australian Council of Trade Unions (ACTU). It plays a key role in wage fixing in Australia through submissions in National Wage Cases which set minimum rates of pay for award-covered employees.

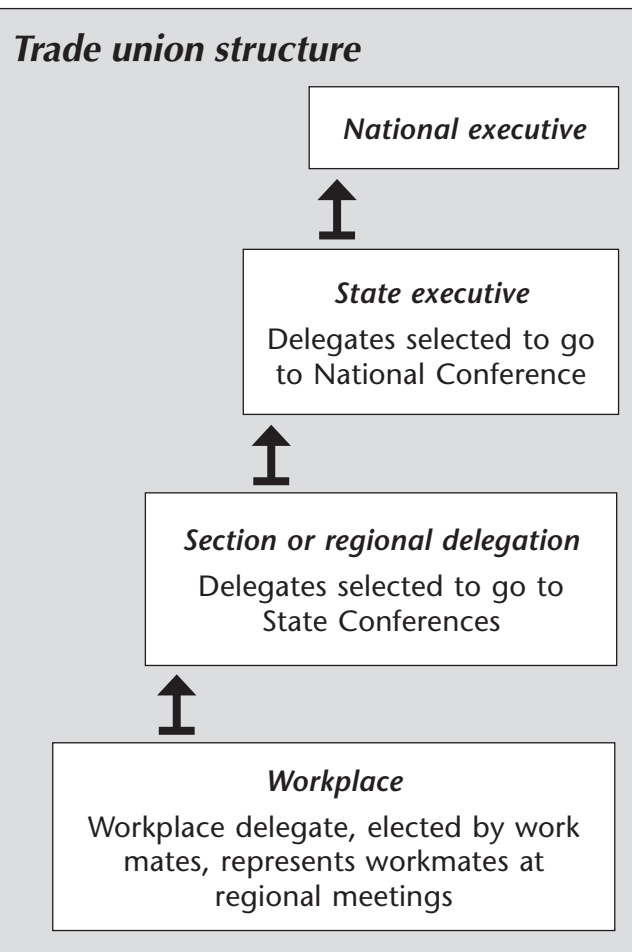
Do I have to join a union?

You do not have to join a union. Federal laws make it illegal to either compel anyone to join a union or to prevent them from doing so. It is also illegal to discriminate against a person for either joining or choosing not to join a union.

What benefits are there in joining a union?

Unions can represent their members in the following areas:

- Negotiate the terms and conditions of awards and enterprise agreements or Australian Workplace Agreements (AWAs) with employers.
- Investigate suspected breaches of award or underpayment of wages.
- Resolve industrial disputes.
- Advise on health and safety and workers' compensation issues.
- Investigate unfair dismissals and redundancies.
- Investigate sexual harassment and discrimination claims.
- Discuss superannuation issues.



Which union to join?

Each trade union has rules which allow it to cover certain types of work or certain trades. Advice on which union to join may come from your employer or the ACTU, which has offices (called Trades and Labour Councils) in all capital cities and regional areas throughout Australia. Most major unions are affiliated with the ACTU.

Once you become a member of a union you are bound by its rules and are obliged to pay membership fees. You must give notice if you intend to resign from the union for any reason, e.g. if you are no longer going to work in the industry.

Some of the larger unions in Australia are:

- Australian Services Union
- Community and Public Sector Union
- Australian Manufacturing Workers Union
- Shop, Distributive & Allied Employees Union
- Liquor, Hospitality & Miscellaneous Workers Union
- Association of Professional Engineers, Scientists & Managers, Australia

STRANGE BUT TRUE!

There has been a determined struggle by workers to cooperate together for better working conditions since Australia was settled in 1788. In 1822, James Straighter, who was a convict shepherd, was sentenced to 500 lashes, one month solitary confinement and five years penal servitude for... 'inciting his Masters' servants to combine for the purposes of obliging him to raise the wages and increase their rations'.

Activities

- 1 Write a definition of a trade union in your own words.
- 2 What factors caused trade union membership to decrease over the past 50 years?
- 3 What evidence is there that trade union membership is no longer declining? Explain.
- 4 What was the percentage of the total workforce who were members of a trade union in August 2005?
- 5 What is the ACTU? What are its main functions?
- 6 What might be the advantages of union amalgamations?
- 7 Liam is a barman who works at a local hotel. Which trade union would he be most likely to join?
- 8 Ethan works as a filing clerk for a state government department. Which union should he join?
- 9 Suggest two occupations for which membership of the Shop, Distributive and Allied Employees Union would be appropriate.
- 10 Sienna is not a member of a trade union. She has recently been subjected to sexual harassment in her workplace. If you were a union delegate at her workplace, what would you advise her to do?
- 11 Fiona is a union organiser who has been asked to speak to a group of employees describing some of the fringe benefits of joining a union. Write out a list of points which Fiona could mention in her talk.
- 12 Make up a table with two columns, and outline the arguments for and against joining a trade union.
- 13 Is membership of a trade union a controversial issue in today's work environment? Explain.



Construct a Venn diagram on the pros and cons of joining a trade union. Use the information above as a guide.

14 Paying income tax.....

Income tax is a percentage of each individual's income that is paid to the government. The money raised is used to pay for government services and other expenditures. There are several types of taxes, such as income tax, company tax and the Goods and Services Tax (GST).

As an employee you are required to pay personal income tax. Under the Pay As You Go (PAYG) system, employers are required to withhold tax from the payments they make to you and send it to the Tax Office regularly. When you lodge your income tax return at the end of the financial year, you are entitled to a credit for the amount of tax which has been withheld from your pay. From the information you provide on your tax return, the Tax Office works out how much tax is payable on your income and whether you have paid more or less tax than required. If you have paid too much tax, you are entitled to a refund, but if you have not paid enough tax, you will have to pay the difference.

The financial year is from 1 July to 30 June the next year. You have from 1 July to 31 October to lodge your tax return unless it is prepared by a registered tax agent. Using a tax agent is becoming increasingly popular with taxpayers because of the complexity of the tax system and the tax return. When you lodge your tax return you need to quote your tax file number (TFN). This is a unique number issued by the Tax Office. Only one TFN is issued to you for your lifetime. Information on tax returns is available on the Australian Tax Office's website (www.ato.gov.au).

Lodging your tax return

A tax return is a document in which you declare your annual income so it can be assessed for tax. The Tax Office provides the form for you to complete your tax return.

You can lodge a tax return in paper form using TaxPack, or to do it more quickly, you can lodge online using e-tax. It is done over the Internet using a special software package which can be downloaded from the ATO website. It helps you prepare your tax return by doing many of the calculations for you, based on figures you provide. It also gives you an estimate of your tax liability for the year and whether you will have a refund or tax debt.

Calculating your tax refund or tax payable

You do not have to pay tax on your total income. The Tax Office will allow you certain deductions for work-related expenses, e.g. the purchase of tools is an allowable deduction for a carpenter, electrician or plumber. You can claim work-related travel expenses but not the cost of travelling from home to work. Other allowable deductions include self-education expenses if the course is directly related to your job, and gifts and donations to registered charities. After you subtract these deductions from your total income, you arrive at your taxable income which is the amount you have to pay tax on. Under the PAYG system, you have already paid some tax so whether you receive a tax refund or have to pay tax depends on whether you have paid more or less tax than you should have.

Emma works in an office and bought a computer for \$3000 in July 2006. She uses her computer for work 60% of the time. As a result she can claim 60% of the decline in value of the computer over a period, e.g. 4 years. This is a work-related expense.

Chanda also works in an office but has enrolled in a TAFE cooking course. This course has nothing to do with his work so he cannot claim self-education expenses.

Emma's tax return

Emma works as a computer operator and received a total income for the year of \$45 000. She had work-related deductions of \$5000. Her taxable income was therefore \$40 000.

Emma had paid \$8200 in tax instalments under the PAYG system. The tax payable on her taxable income (under the tax scales) was \$7800. Therefore Emma received a tax refund of \$400.

Tax return for individuals	
Tax file number:	
Name:	
Address:	
Date of birth:	
INCOME	
Salary or wages:	
Allowances (tips, fees, etc.):	
Other income (interest, dividends, etc.):	
TOTAL INCOME:	
DEDUCTIONS	
Work-related expenses:	
Self-education expenses:	

Gifts or donations:	
TOTAL DEDUCTIONS:	
TAXABLE INCOME:	
TAX PAYABLE ON TAXABLE INCOME (according to tax scales):	
TAX WITHHELD (under PAYG)	
TAX REFUND/ TAX PAYABLE DUE:	
Taxpayer's Declaration:	
	Signature of taxpayer

Activities

- 1 What is meant by the following terms?
a PAYG **c** taxable income **e** tax withheld
b TFN **d** e-tax
- 2 Why do you think the financial year is from July to June instead of from January to December?
- 3 Describe the different ways you can lodge a tax return. What are the advantages and disadvantages of each way?
- 4 What are the arguments for and against using a tax agent to lodge your tax return?
- 5 What are tax deductions? Give three examples.
- 6 Why was Emma allowed to claim a deduction for her computer while Chanda was not allowed to claim his self-education expenses?
- 7 Use the simplified tax return form above to show how Emma's tax return was calculated.
- 8 Chanda had a total income of \$100 000. His total allowable deductions were \$20 000. The tax payable on his taxable income was \$22 000. He had already paid tax instalments of \$23 000 under the PAYG system.
a What was Chanda's taxable income?
b What was Chanda's tax refund?
- 9 What would have been the situation if Chanda's tax installments had been \$20 000?
- 10 Why do you think the taxpayer's declaration is so important? What would happen if you forgot to sign it?



Use the ATO website at www.ato.gov.au to download a tax return. Practise filling it in using fictitious figures and calculate the tax refund or tax payable.

15 Superannuation.....

Ella and Louis had just left school and were successful in gaining employment in an insurance office. They knew a fair bit about their rates of pay and general working conditions such as leave entitlements, but they confessed they knew nothing about superannuation. After all, it would be a long time before they retired. They felt however, that they should at least find out a bit about it so they asked their supervisor at work. Here is a record of their interview.

Ella



What is superannuation all about?

Supervisor



Superannuation is really a way of saving for your retirement. As employers, we must pay superannuation contributions on behalf of all our employees. This compulsory

contribution is called the superannuation guarantee. For all employees between the ages of 18 and 70 who are paid \$450 or more in a calendar month, their employer makes superannuation guarantee contributions to a super fund which complies with government guidelines. It does not matter if you are a full-time, part-time or casual employee.

Louis



How much do they contribute?

Supervisor



Employers must contribute a minimum of 9% (the charge percentage) of employees' earnings base to a complying superannuation fund or a retirement savings account. This

is normally done every three months. It is important to know that the superannuation guarantee is the responsibility of employers. Employees are not obliged to pay or do anything. However, as employees you can contribute your own money towards your retirement, as a sort of investment in the future.

Ella



What is a superannuation fund?

STRANGE BUT TRUE!

- ✦ The Bank of NSW, now Westpac, began Australia's first superannuation fund in 1862 for its long-serving employees. In 2006, superannuation was worth \$700 billion and is expected to reach \$2.3 trillion in ten years.

Supervisor



Superannuation funds are financial organisations which are run by trustees. Their responsibility is to ensure your money is invested with care. Each has its own rules but must also follow government rules that are designed to ensure all superannuation is properly managed.

Louis



I suppose superannuation will give you more money to live on when you retire than the age pension would provide.

Supervisor



The aim of the superannuation guarantee is to ensure as many Australians as possible enjoy the benefits of an income in their retirement. Superannuation does not replace the age pension. It remains for those who need it but for most people superannuation savings will replace or supplement the age pension to provide a greater level of retirement income.

Ella



What happens if you change jobs?

Supervisor



No problem. Your benefits accumulate no matter how many employers you have over your working life.

Louis



OK, when I retire, how do I get the money that is owed to me?

Supervisor When you leave us, you will receive a range of final payments. Many of these payments are known as eligible termination payments (ETPs). You may be terminating employment because you are changing jobs, you could be made redundant, you could be unable to work due to permanent disability, you could be dismissed or you could be retiring. Whatever the reason, these final payments may consist of unpaid wages, unpaid annual leave, unpaid long service leave, pay in lieu of notice, and bona fide redundancy and approved early retirement scheme payments.

Ella Yes, but how do we actually get the money?

Supervisor You have three payment choices. First, you can roll-over all of the payment to a fund for your retirement savings. Second, you can take a cash payment and third, you can take part of the payment in cash and roll-over part of the payment to a fund for your retirement savings. You can roll-over your ETP to a superannuation fund, an approved deposit fund or a life insurance company fund.

Louis What if I find I am broke. Can I get my superannuation money early?

Supervisor Not really. Superannuation is money invested for your retirement. Early access to preserved superannuation benefits can only occur in very limited and restricted circumstances, including severe financial hardship or on compassionate grounds.

Ella Is there anything else to know about superannuation?

Supervisor Yes. Superannuation can be quite complex. There are issues such as tax, preserved benefits and non-preserved benefits, and all sorts of government regulations which do change over time. Even though you may be a long way off retirement, you need to keep up to date with what is happening.

Ella Thanks for your advice.

Louis Yeah, thanks.

Activities

- 1 What is superannuation?
- 2 What obligation does the employer have in relation to superannuation?
- 3 What must the employee do?
- 4 What is meant by the following terms?

a the superannuation guarantee	b a superannuation fund	c a complying fund
d roll-over	e ETP	
- 5 Do you lose anything if you change jobs? Explain.
- 6 Does superannuation replace the age pension? Explain.
- 7 Can you get your superannuation benefits before retirement age? Explain.
- 8 What do you think is meant by the term 'preserved benefit'? How is it used?
- 9 What payment options do you have when you retire?
- 10 **a** Why do you think Ella and Louis decided to ask about superannuation?
b Do you think it is relevant when you are young? Why?

16 Applying for a job.....

Daniel Lyons and Lucy Tan have just completed Year 12 at Orangeville High School. This is a record of their conversation.

Daniel: Since we're leaving school next week I think I'll apply for a job.

Lucy: Yes, me too. What are you going to do?

Daniel: I thought I'd just front up to a few places and see what they've got.

Lucy: I don't think it's that easy Daniel. We need to do some preparation. Are you after a part-time job or holiday job? Or do you want this to be the start of your chosen career?

Daniel: I hadn't really thought about it.

Lucy: Do you have an up-to-date résumé?

Daniel: Not really. I have a few bits of paper and certificates in a folder somewhere at home.

Lucy: I've organised a job file. It contains my birth certificate, school reports, including the most recent ones, personal references from family friends and a school reference. I also have work experience reports as well as certificates and awards from my cricket and basketball teams. I used all that to prepare my résumé.

Daniel: That's a good idea. I should do that too.

Lucy: Make copies of your original documents to send to employers so that you keep the originals.

Daniel: All right. Now, how are you going to go about getting a job?

Lucy: I'm going to write a letter applying for that job at the Ace Sports Store advertised in last Saturday's *Bigtown Gazette*. But there are lots of other ways of looking for a job. Apart from the newspapers, we can check on the Internet, we can make direct approaches to employers – they call that 'cold calling' – or we could contact an employment agency.

Daniel: What about going to Centrelink? Will they help?

Lucy: Yes, we can register our names there as looking for work.

Daniel: I might try the Internet first as they have some good jobsearch sites.

Lucy: I think we need to be pretty active. We could write letters, knock on doors, fill out application forms, leave our telephone number, show we're interested and keen. All that is supposed to help.

Daniel: OK. Thanks for your advice Lucy. Good luck! I'd better get cracking.



A Letter of application

84 Frederick Street
Orangeville 8030

15 October 2006

The Personnel Manager
Ace Sports Store Pty Ltd
555 Cherry Street
BIGTOWN 8001

Dear Personnel Manager

I wish to apply for the position of sales assistant as advertised in last Saturday's *Bigtown Gazette*.

This year I am completing Year 12 at Orangeville High School and would like to pursue a career in retail. I am very interested in sport and have represented the school in cricket and basketball.

I have already had some work experience in a sports store earlier this year and I enjoyed it very much.

I have enclosed a copy of my résumé and look forward to hearing from you.

Yours faithfully

Lucy Tan

Activities

- 1 In the conversation between Daniel and Lucy, describe the difference in attitude between the two in relation to looking for a job.
- 2 What is a 'job file'? Why is it important to prepare one? What should it contain?
- 3 How would applying for a part-time or holiday job differ from applying for a career job?
- 4 What methods could you use to find a job? Why is it important to use more than one method?
- 5 Rufina likes working with animals and she also likes the outdoors. If you were advising her, what types of jobs do you think she should apply for?
- 6 Yusuf is a shy, quiet person who is about to apply for a job. His mother wants him to be a journalist or a television reporter. What career advice would you give to Yusuf?
- 7 Julia loves to sing and she has also learnt music. She wants to work in a band and be a famous rock star. What advice would you give Julia?
- 8 Doug has an ambition to be a doctor but his school grades are poor. What career advice would you give Doug?
- 9 What is Centrelink? Where is your nearest Centrelink office?
- 10 What advice would you give to a person who is filling out a job application form?
- 11 How might this advice be different if it were an Internet application?
- 12 Read the letter of application from Lucy Tan.
 - a What skills do you think Lucy will bring to the job if it is offered to her?
 - b What additional skills do you think she will develop as she gains more experience in the job?
 - c Imagine you are the Personnel Manager for the Ace Sports Store. Write a letter to Ms Tan offering her a job interview.



Prepare your own job file folder and organise it in sections.

Use the Internet to check out jobsearch sites. List three jobsearch sites and indicate which you believe to be the most useful. Explain why.

Find three jobs that you are interested in applying for. Write application letters for them, and workshop the letters with another student.

17 Preparing a resume.....

A résumé is a summary of a person's educational, professional and personal details and experience, as prepared by a job applicant. It is also called a curriculum vitae or CV.

Ahmed Malik and Lynelle Brook, both residents of Lake Beauty, left school and wanted to apply for a job. They each prepared a résumé, as shown below.

Name:	Ahmed Halal Malik
Address:	27 High Street, Lake Beauty
Phone no.:	09 88886543
Date of birth:	27 July 1988
Education:	Lakes District Community College Gained Higher School Certificate, passed all subjects
Work experience:	– Merrick and Partners, Solicitors 3 weeks – Australian Law Society 2 weeks
Interests:	Athletics, school Athletics Champion 2004, 2005 Football, member of school first grade team 2004,2005 Reading
Other skills:	Touch Typing Course at Lake Beauty TAFE College
Referees:	• Dr John Noble, 18 Smith Street, Lake Beauty • Prof Warwick Ryan, Professor of Law, Lake Beauty University

Name:	Lynelle Brook
Address:	14 Riley Street, Lake Beauty
Phone no.:	09 88772107
Date of birth:	15 January 1990
Education:	Lake Beauty High School Completed year 10
Work experience:	Woolworths shop assistant, 2 weeks
Interests:	Movies Meeting people
Referees:	– Mr Ken Jones, 3 Lennon Avenue, Lake Beauty. Phone: 09 3456 6555 – Ms Angela Wong, 78 Amos Street, Lake Beauty. Phone: 09 9876 3456

Activities

- 1 What is the purpose of a résumé or a CV? Why is it so important?
- 2 Study the resumes of Ahmed and Lynelle.
 - a How are the two résumés different?
 - b What type of career do you think Ahmed could pursue?
 - c What type of career do you think Lynelle could pursue?
 - d What are the differences between a good résumé and a poor résumé?
- 3 What role does previous experience play in finding a job?
- 4 Make a list of particular interests and skills which you believe might impress employers. Explain the reasons for your choices.
- 5 Imagine that you are an employer and you have received 150 job applications with accompanying résumés. What are the key things you would be looking for?
- 6 Do you think it is acceptable to submit a hand-written résumé? Is presentation important? Explain.
- 7 Is it worthwhile to use professional help in preparing a résumé? Explain the circumstances where this might be a useful idea.



In small groups, prepare your own résumé. Discuss your work with group members as you go. Check the Internet for different styles of résumés. Compare and contrast the different styles, indicating your own personal preference.

18 Work experience.....

Work experience

- Allows students to explore and experience the world of work
- Aims to broaden students' experience of career opportunities
- Allows students to observe different aspects of work within an industry and in certain cases, allows them to complete tasks allocated by their supervisor
- Gives students an assessment by the school according to school-based criteria
- Asks employers to give feedback on the performance of the students in the workplace. In general, employers are happy to take work experience students. Work experience can be of mutual benefit to all concerned.

Victoria and **Albert** are two year 10 students who joined their school's work experience program.

Victoria decided that she would look for work experience opportunities herself. She was very interested in medicine and had good school grades, especially in science subjects. She decided to approach a local hospital to see if they would take her for two weeks of work experience. Armed with a covering letter from her school, Victoria confidently approached the hospital's administration staff and showed them her school record and her résumé. The hospital responded that they would be delighted to have her as a work experience student.

Albert was not so pro-active. Instead, he relied on the school's careers advisor to help him gain a placement. After several offers, he accepted a work experience placement in a local newsagency. On his first day of work experience, Albert was late, and when asked for his résumé or some recent school reports, he said he had forgotten to bring them.

Some states and territories make Occupational Health and Safety lessons compulsory before work experience can take place. There may be regulations in place, for instance where school students might be handling animals or dangerous equipment in a factory situation.

Vocational Education and Training (VET): is a nationally recognised training available to senior secondary school students as part of their normal school curriculum. Students have the opportunity to complete their secondary education with a senior secondary certificate qualification, a university entrance score or equivalent, and practical work skills and a VET qualification.

Activities

- 1 Explain the difference between a work experience program and a vocational education and training program.
- 2 Do you think that work experience is a useful way of gaining some experience or insight into the nature of particular jobs?
- 3 Describe situations where work experience is:
a useful to the employer **b** no use at all **c** actually a waste of an employer's time.
- 4 How did Victoria's attitude to work experience differ from Albert's?
- 5 Explain the importance of attitude in a work experience placement.
- 6 How important are matters such as dress, behaviour and language?
- 7 Who do you think would have gained the most from their work experience, Victoria or Albert? Explain.
- 8 How could you benefit the most from work experience?



Write two role play scripts describing the likely experiences of Victoria and Albert in their respective work experience placements.

In small groups, discuss the personal successes and failures each member has had with a work experience program.

19 The job interview.....

Types of interviews

- Simple one-on-one interview
- Simple interview before a panel
- Complex series of interview sessions (which may involve psychometric testing)

Types of questions

- Open questions, e.g. 'Tell us a little about ...'
- Hypothetical questions, e.g. 'What would you do if ...'
- Double-barrelled questions – two or more questions linked to the same topic
- Behavioural questions, e.g. 'What is your view of ...'
- Multiple choice questions – used in aptitude tests

What is psychometric testing?

Psychometric tests aim to measure attributes such as intelligence, aptitude and personality. This provides an employer with an insight into how you might cope with stress, how well you work with other people, and how ambitious or motivated you are.

Types of tests

Aptitude tests: these are used to assess your numerical and verbal abilities, your spatial reasoning skills and comprehension. They tend to use multiple-choice type questions.

Example: Which of the following is the odd one out?

- A car
- B train
- C bus
- D bank

Obviously answer D is correct as the others are all forms of transport. Of course, there are more difficult questions than this. Some tests may also involve computer skills which test knowledge and application of computer programs.

Personality tests: these are not a mystery. You can find examples in magazines, books and on the Internet. Many are of dubious quality, but a good test is one which is proven to be reliable by extensive research and developed over time. Often there are no right or wrong answers, but responses can indicate how people think, how they view particular issues and what their interests and motivations are. From personality tests, psychologists develop a profile indicating which type of person you are.

Example: Which of the following statements best sums you up as a person?

- A I enjoy organising other people.
- B I have a wide circle of friends.
- C I look for variety in tasks.
- D I always feel calm and relaxed.

Group tests: for some jobs, group tests may be used. You may be put with a group of other people and asked to build something with blocks, or with string, glue and newspaper. In these situations, employers are looking for people who are innovative and have lots of ideas, as well as people who can work co-operatively in a group situation.

Psychometric testing does not provide all the answers. However, it does provide an indicator of a person's character, aptitudes and preferences, to assist both employers and employees to find the best match of individual to occupation and working environment. It is not supposed to replace interviews or reference checking. Some companies may rely too heavily on these tests and as a result fail to employ some excellent people. Other experts believe they are very accurate in that they assess personal traits that may affect job performance and work behaviour.

STRANGE BUT TRUE!

- ☞ A recent survey of 230 Australian organisations showed over 60 per cent used personality testing.

Sample interview – Applicant No. 1

Interviewer: Good morning Emilio. Please take a seat. How are you today?

Applicant: Good morning Mr Singh. Yes I am very well thank you.

Interviewer: Now, could you tell me why you think you would be the right person for this job?

Applicant: Well, I believe I have the right skills for the work, I have researched some information about the industry in general and I am highly motivated to do well.

Sample interview – Applicant No. 2

Interviewer: Good morning Toni. Please take a seat. How are you today?

Applicant: Er, yeah, I'm OK.

Interviewer: Now, could you tell me why you think you would be the right person for this job?

Applicant: Umm, well I suppose ... ahh, I want a job and I thought this one would be as good as any.

Activities

- 1 Read the two sample interviews.
 - a What differences in attitude is there between the two applicants?
 - b Which applicant do you think was better prepared for the interview? Explain.
 - c What other differences did you find between the two applicants?
 - d Write 10 more lines for each interview, showing how you expect them to continue.
 - e Who would be most likely to get the job? Why?
- 2 What is psychometric testing and why is it used in the job interview process?
- 3 What are the dangers of using psychometric testing to select candidates for a particular job? Give an example.
- 4 What do aptitude tests measure?
- 5 What is the purpose of personality tests?
- 6 Study the following list of characteristics which might be necessary for particular jobs. Select two characteristics you feel are important for each job listed.
List of characteristics: innovative, adaptable to change, customer-focused, good interpersonal skills, task-oriented
Jobs

a accountant	b supervisor in a department store	c computer programmer
d university lecturer	e advertising executive	
- 7 Imagine you are in a job interview for a job you would love to have. The following questions are put to you. In two or three sentences, write down your responses to these questions.
 - a Why do you want to work for us?
 - b What are your short-term goals?
 - c Where do you see yourself in five years' time?
 - d What do you see as your main strengths?
- 8 What is the difference between an open question and a hypothetical question? Give an example of each.



In small groups, make a list of questions you would ask if you were a personnel officer of a large bank interviewing a school leaver for a position. What qualities would you be looking for in the applicant? In your group, act out the interview.

20 Career planning.....

The most logical way to approach a career choice is to analyse yourself in relation to your interests and your abilities. In today's job market, it is important to look at your interests in a broad and open way. For example, 'I like helping people', 'I like working with mechanical things', 'I like being outside and working with animals', rather than 'I want to be a vet, or a car mechanic' as this narrows the job opportunities.

Look at your skills in a broad sense, at what are called 'transferable skills', such as being good with numbers, computer keyboard skills, knowledge of mechanics of cars. In this way, these skills can be used for a wide range of jobs.

If you have special skills your school record (reports, references and other documents) should provide you with a useful guide.

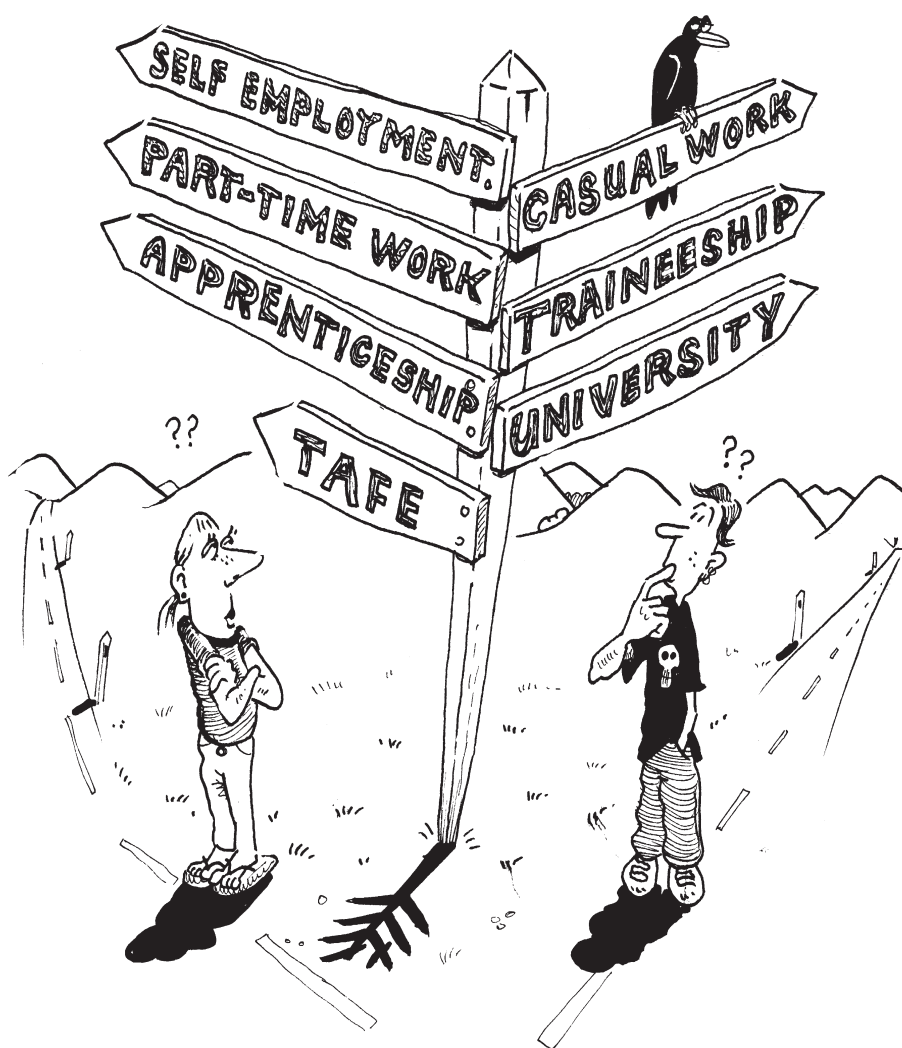
Vocational pathways

In the past, young people were advised that after they left school they should train for a life-long career. Today, you can expect to spend some of your working life as a casual or part-time worker, you may be unemployed for some periods of time and you are likely to be involved in retraining or professional development programs. It is highly likely that your career path will change several times during your working life.

There is much more flexibility today in the vocational pathways available to young people. Universities, for example, are now taking more mature-age students than ever before.

Workplace Training

Unskilled people find it more difficult to find a job than those who are skilled in some way. This may involve formal education, e.g. at a university or TAFE, but it is also important to get 'on-the-job' training. Training, and therefore skills acquisitions, should be seen as a lifelong process. All workers can improve their skills, no matter how experienced they are.



Traditional pathway

School → University → Job

Flexible pathways

School → Job → TAFE course → Job → University →
Job → School → Travel → Job → University →
TAFE course → Job → ?

Technological change is occurring at such a rapid rate that it is very difficult to predict what sorts of jobs will be in demand in the future. You may even find yourself working in occupations which at present do not exist. Workers who lose their jobs may need to retrain, perhaps in an entirely new field. This can be an exciting and satisfying experience.

STRANGE BUT TRUE!

☞ Today, average retention per job per employee is just 4 years.

Government support

Governments and education authorities in Australia are conscious of the need to assist young people to develop career pathways by:

- encouraging and supporting all young people to engage in post-compulsory learning
- recognising a wider variety of patterns of participation in learning and employment (flexible pathways)
- facilitating easier transitions through and between learning and employment
- providing effective individual pathway planning and transition support.

Activities

- 1 What is the difference between a lifelong career and a vocational pathway?
- 2 Why is it expected that most young people will have career path changes during their working life?
- 3 'There is no such thing as a job for life. Employers rarely offer it and employees are rarely interested in it.' Do you agree with this quotation or do you think it is an exaggeration? Explain your views.
- 4 Dimitri is in Year 10 and wants to go to university to study engineering. His marks were very good in all subjects except maths. His maths teacher feels he will find the required higher level of maths too difficult, but his parents think he should go on. What do you suggest Dimitri should do?
- 5 Lee is 16 years old and wants to leave school to get an apprenticeship. Her parents are separated and she lives with her mother, who is struggling financially. Her father believes she should go on to complete her studies up to year 12 and then enter a university. Lee has the ability but has not worked as hard as she could. What options does Lee have?
- 6 Tora has been granted entry to a university but wishes to defer her studies and travel overseas for a year. Tora's parents are against the idea. If you were Tora, how would you explain the benefits of a 'gap year' to your parents?
- 7 Nick failed to gain entry to a university to study law so he enrolled in a TAFE course to gain computing skills. How might these skills help him to find employment? Could he ultimately gain entry to university and study law? How?
- 8 Make a list of the people who have either helped or influenced you in your search for careers information. What else do you think you need to know? Where will you find it?
- 9 Why is retraining so important? Which people are most affected?
- 10 How do governments and educational authorities help young people in their career planning?



Working in groups, make a list in two columns of your interests and your abilities. Can you see any connection between the two? What career choices does this suggest to you? Share your lists with other members of the group.

21 Promotion.....

Case study

Nathan said that he was not aware of all the options available to him after finishing Year 12. 'I planned to go on to do a law degree after Year 12 although I wasn't really looking forward to all the study involved. I thought twice about it, however, when I was offered training in the hospitality industry'. During Year 12, Nathan was employed as a part-time dishwasher at a local hotel. On completion of his final year, Nathan's employer encouraged him to commence a traineeship. With further information about the hospitality traineeship and the enthusiasm of his employer, Nathan decided that this just might turn out to be his preferred vocation. He always enjoyed working with people and he felt that the industry offered good career prospects.

Nathan learned a broad range of skills during his traineeship and was soon involved in organising functions, weddings and other important events. He said, 'I am ready for more responsibility and have my sights set on a management or supervisory position'.

Nathan says he learnt quickly during his traineeship due mainly to being able to put his newly acquired skills into practice.

Nathan was one of a class of 10 hospitality trainees. He said, 'I made some very good friends during my training. We compared our different work environments and learnt from each other. We still see each other regularly, and who knows, given the nature of the hospitality industry, some of us might become very successful indeed'.

Although Nathan did well, promotion is not always an automatic process. If you want to progress in your career you should take active steps rather than waiting to be tapped on the shoulder.

Self-assessment

Your qualifications:

This includes your formal education as well as informal qualifications like courses and workshops.

Your skills:

This may include writing, negotiating, organisational and problem-solving skills.

Your experience:

Experience gained at work, such as positions held and duties associated with them

Your personal attributes:

This would include reliability, a sense of humour, honesty, integrity and adaptability.



Your knowledge:

This may include content-specific knowledge about an area of work or a specific issue you have been working on, as well as knowledge about people, networks, and procedures and processes.

Your values:

Consider what you value and look for in a job and company, such as a good work ethic, self-management as well as the geographic location of a job.

Some useful tips

- Work out what you want to achieve, and draw up a plan of how you will do it. Acquiring new skills may be necessary.
- Look for opportunities. You may be able to come up with a more efficient process for something you are working on, or you may look for ways to gain new experiences.
- Do some networking. Remember, 'It is not what you know but who you know'. The more you know about the organisation you work for, the better. Usually the best way to learn about an organisation is to talk to people who already work there.

- Keep abreast of issues and new trends in your line of work by reading journals, surfing the Internet and attending relevant conferences.
- Take stock of your achievements. Compile a record of all work-related achievements, samples of great work, letters of recognition and other materials that demonstrate good job performance.
- Consider a horizontal move. It may be better to make a sideways move to a job at your current level in the short term so you can learn new skills that will help you move upwards in the future.
- Be pro-active. Let your supervisor know that you are interested in progressing and learning more.
- Approach someone to act as your mentor. This is usually a more experienced person who can take you 'under their wing' and help develop your skills.
- Improve your skills. This is particularly important if you see a skills gap between the job you have now and the one you want.

STRANGE BUT TRUE!

- ☞ Market research has revealed that 22% of workers in Australia take less than half their annual holidays.

Dangers

Seeking and gaining rapid promotion may be great, but you need to consider other factors, such as your health and your personal relationships. Is promotion worth it if you have a breakdown, or if you lose valuable friends? Working extremely long hours with not enough time for rest and leisure activities can cause problems. Taking annual leave is also an important part of this. Many Australians now are not taking their annual leave because they fear that their job may not be there when they return, or the employer may discover that they can get along well without them. Some are just too absorbed in their job to take leave. Taking holidays is an important part of the balance between work and leisure.

Activities

- 1 'Everybody eventually gets promoted.' Is this statement true or false? Explain.
- 2 What would motivate some people to seek promotion?
- 3 How was Nathan able to achieve his promotion? What factors helped him in this?
- 4 How is a plan useful in seeking promotion?
- 5 Explain what is meant by: **a** mentoring **b** networking
- 6 How useful do you think the Internet is in seeking advice about promotion?
- 7 Use an Internet search engine to find out more useful information about promotion in the workplace. Write a brief description of one piece of useful advice you found.
- 8 What is meant by being pro-active in seeking promotion? Why is it important?
- 9 Why is skills acquisition so important?
- 10 Antonio had worked in an office doing clerical work for five years. He worked hard and always completed the tasks he was assigned. One day he decided he would chase promotion and become a supervisor. What steps would you advise him to take in seeking a promotion?



In groups, discuss the topic 'Your education does not end when you leave school'. How is this relevant to getting ahead in your chosen career?

22 Work wordfind.....

Find the words listed below in the wordfind. They may be horizontal, vertical or diagonal, forwards or in reverse. The remaining letters form a phrase which concerns all workers.

- superannuation
- salary
- work
- deductions
- strike
- overtime
- June
- hours of work
- money
- income tax
- gross wage
- leave
- prospects
- jobs
- duties
- award
- bonus
- vacancy
- trade union
- net wage
- adjustments
- P.A.Y.E.
- long service
- health funds
- holidays
- cost of living

S	E	V	E	K	R	O	W	F	O	S	R	U	O	H
A	U	S	N	O	I	T	C	U	D	E	D	R	Y	C
L	O	P	S	T	R	I	K	E	V	E	N	E	S	O
A	E	R	E	G	W	H	O	A	N	W	O	B	D	S
R	C	O	T	R	A	D	E	U	N	I	O	N	N	T
Y	I	S	R	O	A	L	J	K	S	J	M	U	U	O
C	V	P	D	S	V	N	E	T	W	A	G	E	F	F
N	R	E	U	S	S	E	N	A	S	O	T	P	H	L
A	E	C	T	W	Y	A	R	U	W	Y	R	T	T	I
C	S	T	I	A	A	E	N	T	A	A	X	K	L	V
A	G	S	E	G	T	O	N	P	I	T	R	O	A	I
V	N	T	S	E	B	H	A	O	E	M	I	D	E	N
H	O	L	I	D	A	Y	S	G	M	O	E	O	H	G
V	L	E	R	N	E	X	A	T	E	M	O	C	N	I
M	E	A	D	J	U	S	T	M	E	N	T	S	N	T

Selected answers

1 THE WORKPLACE

- 1 Fixed-office workers; variable-drivers, repairers, service workers.
- 2 Save on travel costs and time to and from work; more flexible working hours. People with young families –save on child care costs.
- 3 a golf course b office c clothing store d home e farm f factory g building site h university i restaurant j on the road k national park l hospital
- 4 a Talk about inappropriate behaviour, if work is affected give a warning and a second chance.
b Curb behaviour which affects job.
c Yes, behaviour in own time is at discretion of individual, behaviour in workplace must be appropriate.
d Yes, it can be a reflection of a person's personality e.g. loud and aggressive at work and away from work.
- 5 You need to quickly adapt to a new workplace to work efficiently.
- 6 a T b F c F d T e F
- 7 a Gossip at work always inappropriate.
b Ask Jack to stop the gossip.
c He could become the object of gossip.
- 8 a Ask her to give it more time to adjust.
b It should be but perhaps you might like to hang out with Kate.
c No set time, depends on circumstances but several weeks as minimum.
d She becomes more confident and can handle the tasks or is given a raise in pay.

2 PAYMENT FOR WORK

- 1 a wages b salary c rent d fees e dividend f commission g royalties h interest i profit j allowance
- 2 Wages are calculated on weekly basis, salary on an annual basis.
- 3 a \$800 b \$1550 c \$890
- 4 Tax return
- 5 Agent, commission
- 6 The number of books sold and the royalty rate per book.
- 7 More skilled and experienced, or enjoy a higher reputation in their field.
- 8 A list of the amounts charged for each type of service.
a preparation of wills etc. b extraction, filling etc.
- 9 Greater skill and/or experience, work in high demand.
- 10 No, many housewives work for no pay. Also many people do voluntary work.

3 CHANGING WORK PATTERNS

- 1 More services available to people, more technology.
- 2 Robotics engineer, IT consultant.
- 3 Can edit text more easily, can attach documents to emails, can add illustrations to documents.
- 4 a Quicker than letters, can get instant replies (even from overseas contacts).
b Can always be in contact with colleagues or customers wherever you are (provided you are in range).
c Instant contact by email and also by phone using the one device.
d Can use computer without need for power outlet, while travelling, or wherever customers are located.
- 5 Technology and automation have reduced the number of unskilled jobs. People leaving school need to gain some work skills.
- 6 The idea that women stay home while men work is changing. Both men and women are more involved in a wider variety of occupations than ever before.
- 7 a Able to start work early or finish late to suit personal circumstances.
b A day off work to compensate for extra hours worked over a week or fortnight.
- 8 More flexibility, especially if business is slow or company is losing money. Can benefit workers who also want flexibility, but it also brings: loss of job security, penalty rates for overtime, sick leave entitlements etc.
- 9 a World peace and feeding Africa.
b No jobs available which matched those interests.
c Law degree, Arts degree, Food preparation course, Science degree, Professional writing course, Music diploma.

- d It gave her greater experience. Industries function differently in different countries.
- f Probably, her varied life gives many different opportunities for new work experiences.

- 10 Dimi could take family leave to look after children and have a break from work while his wife could return to workforce; both could work part-time and share child minding.
- 11 a Gain experience of the world, gain some maturity before commencing study.
b A gap between school and work.
c Could lose interest and inclination to return to study after travel.
d Could do casual work for a year before university; could study part-time and work part-time.
- 10 The work-place has changed. There is not the same job security, and people have more opportunities for a varied work life.

4 PERMANENT OR CASUAL/FULL-TIME OR PART-TIME

- 1 Cartoon illustrates that someone can be a permanent employee yet appear casual in the way they work. Workers with casual status are not necessarily casual in their behaviour.
- 2 a Large increase, both full-time and part-time.
b Percentage of part-time females has dropped between 1993 and 2006.
c 1993 males 16%, females 84%; 2006 males 28%, females 72%. Illustrates decrease in female and increase in male part-time employment, the result of an increase in female full-time employment.
d 10 054 – 4941 = 5113; increase in population, good economic conditions.
- 3 Nurse, teacher, shop assistant.
- 4 Waitress, cook.
- 5 Can return to workforce part-time, do casual teaching, perhaps use child care, could share child minding with husband. Should not make any difference, both jobs in high demand.
- 6 Joe can take early retirement, apply to do casual work or work on a permanent part-time basis. Advantages are more flexibility and leisure time, disadvantages may be less job satisfaction and lower pay.
- 7 Company could possibly save money, not having to pay some entitlements. Kwan would be disadvantaged by loss of entitlements but might prefer more flexibility in the times he works.
- 8 a Casual, she would need flexible working hours.
b May be permanent.
c Nina would probably be full-time as this is her career.

5 WORKING CONDITIONS

- 1 Dedication to their job, fear of losing job.
- 2 Annual leave- holiday leave, usually 4 weeks per year.
Sick leave- paid leave if too ill to work.
Special leave- paid leave to attend funerals or other special reasons.
Long Service Leave- paid leave for continuous service (usually 10 years or more and not available to every worker).
Leave without pay- unpaid leave for special reasons.
- 3 a Much longer hours of work, 11 hour working day with no lunch hour compared to today's 8 hour working day.
b Greater importance attached to religion in those days, not so today.
c More relaxed dress code today.
e No toilet breaks, no talking, staff expected to clean (although this does apply today in some cases), no lunch hour, staff provide own stationery. Not acceptable today as society attitudes have changed and rules more relaxed.
f Specialisation of tasks in workplace.
h Yes, cabin staff working for Virgin Blue expected to clean planes.
- 4 Special circumstances such as family matters requiring time off.
- 5 A form of saving for eventual retirement. It is a benefit and an entitlement. Government must pay contribution (9%), employees can contribute.
- 6 a Leave for fathers to stay at home and mind children.
b Extra bonuses, such as company car, entertainment allowances.
c Combination of salary plus other benefits.
- 7 87% of full-time workers likely to have leave entitlements compared with 41% of part-time workers.

Selected answers.....

- 8 Jody would not have the benefits of paid leave (annual leave, sick leave etc.). Nina could possibly have additional benefits such as an annual bonus or other fringe benefits but may be expected to work long hours to complete tasks. Jody would be paid only for hours worked.

6 SEXUAL HARASSMENT

- 1 Human rights issue, right to be treated with respect.
- 2 Sexual harassment implies unwelcome and uninvited behaviour usually followed by warnings from victim.
- 3 Yes, can include suggestive comments or jokes, intrusive questioning, display of suggestive material on wall or on computer.
- 4
 - a No, attention was not unwelcomed and mutual agreement to go on a date.
 - b If Emily objected to any of Ming's behaviour, and he persisted.
 - c Would need to examine situation carefully to judge if there actually was harassment. If sexual harassment proven, would need to report matter, if not, advise two employees to resolve differences.
 - d Georgia should report sexual harassment to her supervisor.
 - e If not satisfied, Georgia can report matter to HREOC.
 - f Yes, sexual harassment does not have to be physical and Morag's behaviour was harassment.
 - g If Scott accepts the apology and Morag is genuine they could resume working together.
 - h Warn Morag of seriousness of her behaviour and a repeat could jeopardise her career.
 - i Report Morag to HREOC for sexual harassment, possibly recommend dismissal from workplace.
 - j Ask Scott to reconsider on basis that Morag will be reported and/or dismissed.
- 5 28% of women, 7% of men. It is high considering its seriousness.
- 6 Unwanted physical touching, suggestive jokes or comments, display of suggestive material, discussion of personal sex lives, requesting sexual favours in return for promotion.

7 EQUAL OPPORTUNITY

- 1 Sex, race, marital status, sexual orientation, (also disability), Racial Discrimination Act, Sex Discrimination Act, Disability Discrimination Act, Age Discrimination Act, permanent, casual, full-time, part-time.
- 2 Human Rights and Equal Opportunity Commission. Investigates and acts upon reports of discrimination.
- 3 Favouring or choosing someone purely on the basis of whether they are male or female. An employer refusing to hire a female because they feel she may get pregnant and leave.
- 4 Human rights-all people have the right to be treated equally.
- 5 Help her to manage the task or assign her an easier task if possible.
- 6
 - a No, an example of sex discrimination.
 - b Talk to her boss about it.
 - c Take the matter to HREOC.
 - d Allow Maria to continue her employment until she takes maternity leave.
- 7
 - a Yes, probably on racial grounds.
 - b Yes, under the Racial Discrimination Act.
 - c Talk to his employer to try to resolve the situation, mentioning his belief he is being discriminated against and that it is against the law.
- 8
 - a Yes, on the basis of age.
 - b Network may have right to change its commentators but reason must not be on basis of age alone.
 - c An alternative job in the network or a retirement package or payout.
- 9
 - a Yes, based on discrimination against sexual orientation.
 - b Complain to his employer or take the matter to HREOC.
 - c Sex Discrimination Act.

8 WORKPLACE AGREEMENTS

- 1 An award relates to minimum conditions normally negotiated by a trade union and set by an industrial court, a workplace agreement is an agreement between an individual employee and their employer.
- 2 Conciliation attempts to reach an agreement through conferencing, arbitration involves a decision or judgement by a

court.

- 3 Established the award system and granted industrial courts the power to settle industrial disputes.
 - 4 Historical reasons, state industrial systems operated independently of federal systems.
 - 5
 - a To provide the average family with enough to live reasonably.
 - b Yes, families still need to be able to survive on a basic income.
 - c Wage levels could fall, resulting in some people living in poverty.
 - 6 To conciliate and arbitrate on industrial disputes.
 - 7 Introduction of AWA's.
 - 8 Encouragement of more AWA's, preventing some working conditions from being included in AWA's, removing authority of AIRC, confining unfair dismissal laws to businesses with more than 100 employees, overriding state industrial laws.
 - 9
 - a Reduce their power.
 - b Young workers less able to bargain for pay and conditions due to lack of experience.
 - 10 Employers likely to benefit because they can reduce their costs, especially wage costs.
- ### 9 UNEMPLOYMENT
- 1 No, must be actively looking for work to be considered unemployed.
 - 2 The percentage of population in the labour force, ie. employed or unemployed. Discouraged job seekers, change in the economy.
 - 3 People changing jobs, seasonal work, economic downturn, not trained for jobs available, lack of experience.
 - 4 Difficult to gain necessary skills if unemployed.
 - 5 Some employers impressed with young workers enthusiasm, others exploit their lack of experience.
 - 6
 - a She refused to sign a new work contract.
 - b She would have had less income.
 - c Either sign the contract or become unemployed, perhaps look for another job.
 - 7
 - a Company running into financial difficulties couldn't afford to pay the miners.
 - b Move to a different location, retrain in another field and find another job.
 - 8
 - a He had no skills and no experience in workplace.
 - b Short term, he could continue to look for a job, long term, he would need to consider training to acquire some skills.
 - c Typical of youth unemployment problem, ie. lack of skills and experience.
 - 10
 - a 532 000 b decrease of 4.3% c 5% d 64.5%
 - e remained steady, slight decrease of 0.1%.
 - 11
 - a 1993 (or 1994)
 - b economic downturn.
 - c So that government strategies can be employed to decrease unemployment.
 - 12 Greater number and variety of jobs available in big cities than in smaller towns (more service industries).
 - 13
 - a Discouragement, depression, financial difficulties, loss of self esteem.
 - b Hurts whole families as may be interdependent.
 - 14 Centrelink provides various programs to help unemployed- check website for details.
 - 15 Establish training and retraining programs.
 - 16 Reduce unemployment as more jobs created in growing economy.

10 WORKPLACE PROTECTION

- 1 Occupational Health and Safety, provides regulations for healthy and safe workplaces.
- 2
 - a Painter falling off ladder.
 - b Secure ladder or have scaffolding erected.
 - c Take care to secure ladder, don't over-reach when painting.
 - d Scaffolding must be used on buildings over a certain height.
- 3
 - a Report incident to employer.
 - b To show proof of injury.
 - c Submit work injury report form to WorkCover authority.
 - d WorkCover authority processes claim and pays for medical bills and rehabilitation expenses.

- 4 a Yes, she injured her hand at work.
b Paid medical bills and rehabilitation.
c To provide a safe workplace.
d Yes, no blame attached for carelessness of worker, although they may need to be advised or retrained.
e Workers' compensation payout would have been made.
- 5 a No, workers' compensation only covers accidents or injury while at work.
b She could be charged with fraud if found out.
- 6 Injured people need to receive payout based on their needs + some money for pain and suffering.
- 7 Extremely important, especially in dangerous workplace situations.
- 8 When a job is taken over by automatic machinery, resulting in employees having to retrain for another job.
- 9 Workers need income if unable to work because of an accident at work.
- 10 It is compulsory to protect the workforce in case of accidents. Without insurance, employers could not afford to pay, especially in cases of large claims.

11 EMPLOYMENT RELATIONS

- 1 Appearance is important for first impressions; acceptable behaviour leads to work efficiency.
- 2 Skills which show how well you relate to and communicate with other people, e.g. being a good listener.
- 3 Idea that employees and employers generally work against each other.
- 4 Work buddy generally on same level as employee while mentor assumed to be in a more senior position. Unlikely to be both as mentor usually a more experienced person.
- 5 a-e Matter of opinion, but it is generally assumed there are benefits for both persons concerned, as part of a professional development process.
- 6 a Cartoonist trying to show negative and futile side of office gossip.
b Alan could well be upset, and he might retaliate with his own gossip.
- 7 a She was concerned about behaviour of one of her employees.
b Yes, she has suggested she would like to help and is concerned about office harmony.
c Probably better to talk personally as emails are more impersonal.
d-g own opinion.
- 8 Language is a powerful form of communication and people can be affected differently according to the way it is used.

12 INDUSTRIAL DISPUTES

- 1 a wildcat strike b lockout c arbitration d picket line
e stopwork meeting f sit-down strike g compulsory conference
h lightning strike i penalty rates j rolling strikes
- 2 Penalty rates not being paid.
- 3 They would be forced to take a cut in pay.
- 4 They did not want to pay penalty rates any more. They believed they would save money and increase their profits.
- 5 They could, and did hold a stopwork meeting, they could approach the employer to argue their case, and they could go on strike.
- 6 They implemented a lockout.
- 7 By an industrial court, employees ordered back to work.
- 8 Winners-employers got their way; losers-employees had to take a pay cut or find another job.
- 9 Both sides compromise, especially if business is struggling.
- 10 State of toilets, lunchroom-these are minor problems which do not take much effort to resolve.

13 TRADE UNIONS

- 1 Definition should include phrases like 'groups of workers', 'pay and conditions', 'work together', 'unite'.
- 2 Increase in number of self-employed, changes in attitude, changes in society.
- 3 A 4% increase in union membership from August 2004 to August 2005. Changes to Workplace Relations Act and concern about workers losing their conditions and entitlements.
- 4 $1\,911\,900 \text{ out of } 8\,535\,268 = 22\%$.
- 5 Australian Council of Trade Unions. A type of super union which represents other trade unions at a national level.
- 6 Economies of scale, savings on costs of running a union.

- 7 Liquor, Hospitality and Miscellaneous Workers' Union.
- 8 Community and Public Sector Union.
- 9 Shop assistant, warehouse employee.
- 10 To join the union; this could help her with advice on dealing with sexual harassment.
- 11 Protection of workers' rights, maintenance of pay and working conditions, other benefits such as health insurance, credit cards, discount home loans. Union representation if being harassed or discriminated against at work.

14 PAYING INCOME TAX

- 1 a Pay As You Go b Tax File Number c gross income less deductions, income on which tax is calculated d electronic tax return e tax already paid as instalments under PAYG system.
- 2 January-December is in a holiday period.
- 3 Paper form or electronically. Paper form easier for people who don't have computer skills, e-tax is easier and more convenient.
- 4 Tax agent has financial skills and knowledge of an increasingly complex tax system; have to pay for service.
- 5 Allowable expenses incurred in earning your income and therefore not subject to tax, e.g. equipment used for work, self education expenses related to work, travel within workplace (but not to and from work).
- 6 Emma used her own computer for work while Chanda's self education expenses were not directly related to his work.
- 7 Emma
- | | | |
|-------------------------------|----------|-----------|
| Income | \$45 000 | 8 Chanda |
| Deductions | \$5 000 | \$100 000 |
| Taxable income | \$40 000 | \$20 000 |
| Tax payable on taxable income | \$7 800 | \$80 000 |
| Tax withheld under PAYG | \$8 200 | \$22 000 |
| Tax Refund | \$400 | \$23 000 |
- 9 Chanda would have to pay tax of \$2000.
- 10 It is a legally binding document and therefore requires a signature; it would be returned to you.

15 SUPERANNUATION

- 1 It is a way of saving for retirement.
- 2 Employer must pay 9% of employees' earnings.
- 3 Employees not required to do anything but they can make their own contributions.
- 4 a The compulsory contribution paid by employers.
b A financial organisation which accepts superannuation funds and is subject to government regulations.
c A fund which complies with government regulations.
d Re-investing money in another fund.
e Eligible Termination Payment- the final payments made when you leave a job.
- 5 No, superannuation is portable (transferable to other jobs).
- 6 No, but the more people on superannuation, the less the government must pay out in age pensions (paid to those in need).
- 7 No, only paid on retirement, except in very exceptional circumstances.
- 8 Superannuation funds which are held for you until you retire. You could access some of it in times of very severe financial hardship.
- 9 Take a cash payment, roll-over or re-invest in another financial fund (super fund or life insurance company fund) or any combination of cash and fund investment.
- 10 a They wanted to know all they could about their working conditions and entitlements on retirement even though that was a long way in the future.
b You need to plan early if you want an adequate income when you retire.

16 APPLYING FOR A JOB

- 1 Daniel appeared to be unprepared and very casual, Lucy was organised and motivated.
- 2 A file or folder containing documents used in applying for a job (resume, reports, references, birth certificate, awards). Important to be organised and to have documents required by an employer.
- 3 More thought and preparation needed for a career job, a holiday job is usually just to earn money.
- 4 Newspapers, Internet, telephone calls, personal approach, employment agency; the more methods used, the more chance of success.

Selected answers.....

- 5 Park ranger, gardener, vet, landscape architect.
- 6 Shy, quiet personality may not be suited to TV journalism. What does he want to do, rather than what his mother wants him to do?
- 7 It is difficult to make a reasonable living as a musician. Julia could find a job related to music which could lead to making contacts to help her achieve her goal.
- 8 Doug needs to decide what he really wants to do and then either work harder to achieve his goal, or find a job in a related field.
- 9 A federal government organisation which coordinates assistance for individuals and families in financial need. It also includes assistance for people looking for a job.
- 10 Need to be neat and tidy in completing form, make sure details are accurate.
- 11 Computer does not recognise neatness but need to fill all the compulsory fields on Internet application.
- 12 a Interest and ability in various sports, skills gained from work experience.
b Better communication skills, more sophisticated selling and marketing skills.

17 PREPARING A RESUME

- 1 A summary of a person's personal details and professional qualifications and experience. It is a snapshot to show a prospective employer.
- 2 a Ahmed's resume was more detailed and showed he was more mature and had more qualifications; Lucy's was also well organised but showed less maturity and less qualifications.
b Career in law.
c Career in retail or service industry.
d Good resumes are more detailed, with relevant information, also well organised and easy to read – should not be too long. Poor resumes lack detail and are poorly organised.
- 3 Very important as it informs employer that you have experience in the industry.
- 4 Depends on job you are applying for.
- 5 Well organised, skills and maybe experience relevant to the job.
- 6 A typed resume is usually easier for prospective employer to read and understand.
- 7 Yes, can be useful if applying for a career job.

18 WORK EXPERIENCE AND VOCATIONAL TRAINING

- 1 Work experience is experience working in a particular industry; vocational training is part of school curriculum which leads to an additional qualification.
- 2 Personal opinion.
- 3 a Employer could gain some useful help and also experience in dealing with young people.
b Where attitude of employer and/or student is negative.
c Where a workplace is potentially dangerous and there is nothing constructive for the student to do.
- 4 Victoria was more positive and organised as well as willing to find her own placement. Albert relied on others and was disinterested in the job.
- 5 Very important, it sends signals to others, especially employer, as to what sort of person you are.
- 6 Very important, image and appropriate behaviour create a good impression.
- 7 Probably Victoria as she was organised and had a positive attitude.
- 8 Being prepared, pro-active and positive (willing to learn).

19 THE JOB INTERVIEW

- 1 a Emilio had a more polite and more positive attitude; Toni was abrupt and not very articulate.
b Emilio, because he had thought about the questions he would most likely be asked.
c Emilio had researched the industry and considered how he would be suited to it.
e Emilio, as he was motivated and really wanted the job.
- 2 A series of tests in aptitude, personality etc. It is aimed at finding the right applicant for a job.
- 3 Not always a foolproof method, can sometimes be over-used resulting in less suitable applicants getting the job.
- 4 They measure your natural ability in verbal, mathematical and spatial perception areas.

- 5 To gain a profile of you as a whole person.
- 6 a task oriented b interpersonal skills c innovative d adaptable e innovative, (others can be added).
- 8 Open question invites an individual response, hypothetical question requests a response to a specific set of circumstances.

20 CAREER PLANNING

- 1 Lifelong career is in one particular field, e.g. retailing; vocational pathway involves a series of steps (courses, qualifications, jobs etc.) a person follows during their working life.
- 2 More flexibility in the workplace today, more opportunities for wider experience.
- 4 Dimitri needs to either work harder in this subject or consider a different career.
- 5 Lee needs to consider what she wants to do rather than what others want for her. She could leave school and work to gain needed income and go to university as a mature age student, or get some financial advice to continue now.
- 6 It would provide valuable life experience and enable her to gain some maturity, making it easier to settle down to study when she is ready.
- 7 TAFE courses are generally more practical than university courses and can sometimes be more useful in gaining a job. He could gain entry to university as a mature age student if the university will accept his academic qualifications and experience.
- 9 Technology changing rapidly, new jobs appearing, old ones disappearing. Unskilled people most affected.
- 10 Encouraging and helping people to continue learning after they leave school.

21 PROMOTION

- 1 False, but many people may be surprised that promotion is not always as difficult as they may think.
- 2 Ambition, desire to achieve in life, interest in leadership.
- 3 Gaining experience and completing a traineeship course in his chosen field. He was helped by an interested employer who encouraged him, as well as his desire to achieve.
- 4 Establishes goals, short and long term. Gives a definite path to follow.
- 5 a Mentoring is helping an employee with less experience, status or qualifications to gain those things.
b Networking is establishing useful contacts and communicating effectively with those who may later provide some benefit.
- 6 Very useful, many good websites.
- 8 Anticipating what needs to be done ahead of time and organising yourself to be ready for promotion. You will not be promoted if you sit back and hope it will happen.
- 9 Skills are essential in any job and with new technology, the skills needed keep changing.
- 10 Take more interest in the workings of the office, what other people do, what promoted people do and then work out a plan to seek promotion. Indicate to others a real interest in promotion.

22 WORK WORDFIND

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Use them to supplement your existing resources, to extend student capabilities, for revision purposes, or for class work when the regular teacher is absent.

Living and Work Literacy Book 4

This fourth book in the *Living and Work Literacy* series provides photocopiable activities that explore work education. Throughout these topics, students will investigate different roles in the working environment and the regulations and issues that relate to employment. Concepts are explored through a range of challenging short answer, class discussion and research activities. Each topic is self-contained and selected answers have been provided to make marking time-efficient.

Topics contained in this book are suitable for secondary school subjects in years 7–10 that teach young people about the practical skills and knowledge that they need to participate fully in society. Other books in this series cover topics such as money and being a wise consumer, government and law, and managing small enterprises.

Topics include

The workplace
Changing work patterns
Different types of work agreements
Working conditions
Sexual harassment
Equal opportunity
Unemployment

Industrial disputes
Tax and superannuation
Applying for jobs
Job interviews
Work experience and vocational training
Career planning and promotion



Associated titles in the Instant Lessons series

- Living and Work Literacy (Books 1, 2, 3)
- Civics for Australian Schools (Books 1, 2, 3, 4)
- Instant Lessons in Legal Studies (Books 1, 2, 3)
- Instant Lessons in Family and the Law
- Instant Lessons in Law, Justice and Human Rights



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An imprint of Blake Education Pty Ltd
ABN 074 266 023
108 Main Rd
Clayton South
VIC 3169
+61 3 9558 4433
www.blake.com.au

